OnBuch+

SIGNED COURSE • PREMIUM

ICT • UPPER SIXTH | UPPER SIXTH — ICT

CHAPTER 22

PRODUCING SLIDES THAT DISPLAY ILLUSTRATIVE AND ATTRACTIVE PRESENTATIONS

SUGGESTED TIME: 3 PERIODS

IN THIS CHAPTER

This chapter teaches Upper Sixth students how to plan, produce and deliver attractive slide presentations using presentation software such as Microsoft PowerPoint, LibreOffice Impress or Google Slides. Learners master slide design, multimedia integration, transitions, animations and rehearsal techniques needed for the GCE Advanced Level practical examination and real-life communication.

- By the end of this chapter I can explain the purpose and components of presentation software and its interface.
- By the end of this chapter I can plan a presentation by defining the audience, objective, outline and number of slides.
- By the end of this chapter I can create, save, duplicate, reorder and delete slides using appropriate layouts.
- By the end of this chapter I can apply themes, background styles, master slides and consistent formatting to a presentation.
- By the end of this chapter I can insert and format text, pictures, shapes, tables, charts, audio and video on slides.
- By the end of this chapter I can apply and configure slide transitions with timing and sound options.

DOWNLOAD ONBUCH
Free • Google Play
AI tutor, past papers, results

GO ONBUCH+
All signed courses, unlimited AI tutor, PDF sheets — OnBuch+ tab in the app

THIS SIGNED COURSE CONTAINS

COURSE complete, illustrated, step by step

METHODS and worked examples

EXERCISES exam style + solutions

SUMMARY SHEET the essentials to remember

Signed • OnBuch+
ONBUCH+ TEACHING TEAM
FOLLOWS THE OFFICIAL MINESEC SYLLABUS

OnBuch+

CONTENTS

1. Section 1: Getting Started with Presentation Software and Producing Slides
2. Section 2: Designing Attractive and Consistent Slides
3. Section 3: Multimedia, Transitions and Animations
4. Section 4: Delivering, Printing and Evaluating the Presentation
5. Integration activity
6. Methods and worked examples
7. Exercises
8. Solutions to the exercises
9. Summary sheet

CHAPTER OBJECTIVES

- By the end of this chapter I can explain the purpose and components of presentation software and its interface.
- By the end of this chapter I can plan a presentation by defining the audience, objective, outline and number of slides.
- By the end of this chapter I can create, save, duplicate, reorder and delete slides using appropriate layouts.
- By the end of this chapter I can apply themes, background styles, master slides and consistent formatting to a presentation.
- By the end of this chapter I can insert and format text, pictures, shapes, tables, charts, audio and video on slides.
- By the end of this chapter I can apply and configure slide transitions with timing and sound options.
- By the end of this chapter I can apply entrance, emphasis, exit and motion-path animations to objects and control their order and timing.
- By the end of this chapter I can run a slideshow, use presenter tools, rehearse timings and print handouts.
- By the end of this chapter I can evaluate a presentation against design principles (readability, consistency, the 6×6 rule) and improve it.
- By the end of this chapter I can produce a complete multimedia presentation on a real topic and defend it before an audience.

PREREQUISITES

- Basic file management: creating folders, saving, opening and renaming files (Lower Sixth ICT).
- Word processing skills: entering and formatting text, inserting pictures and tables (Lower Sixth ICT).
- Familiarity with the keyboard, mouse and the general window/menu interface of application software.
- Notions of charts and data representation from spreadsheet work (Lower Sixth ICT).
- Basic knowledge of multimedia file types (images, audio, video) seen in the chapter on multimedia.

1 SECTION 1: GETTING STARTED WITH PRESENTATION SOFTWARE AND PRODUCING SLIDES

During the end-of-year ceremony at GBHS Bamenda, a student is asked to present the school's results to parents and the Divisional Delegate of Secondary Education. He reads long paragraphs from a sheet of paper, head down, while the audience loses interest after five minutes. His classmate, however, projects colourful slides with photos of the prize winners, animated charts of the pass rates and smooth transitions between topics — the hall stays attentive to the very end and the Delegate warmly congratulates the school. **Same information, completely different impact!** In a Cameroon where GCE project defences, business pitches in Douala, church announcements in Yaoundé and political campaign meetings all rely on projected slides, knowing how to produce an **illustrative** and **attractive** presentation is no longer optional. This chapter teaches you to design, enrich and deliver professional slide presentations, and this first section lays the foundations: what presentation software is, how to find your way in its window, and how to create, organise and save your very first slides.

1.1 Presentation Software: Definition, Purpose and Examples

DEFINITION **Presentation software**

Presentation software is an application program used to create a sequence of **slides** — individual screens combining text, images, charts, sound and video — designed to be projected or displayed to an audience in order to support an oral presentation.

The key intuition is simple: a slide is not a document to be read silently like a Word page; it is a **visual support** for what the speaker says. The audience listens to you and glances at the slide. Good presentation software therefore makes it easy to combine short texts, pictures and multimedia, to arrange them in a logical order, and to project them full-screen.

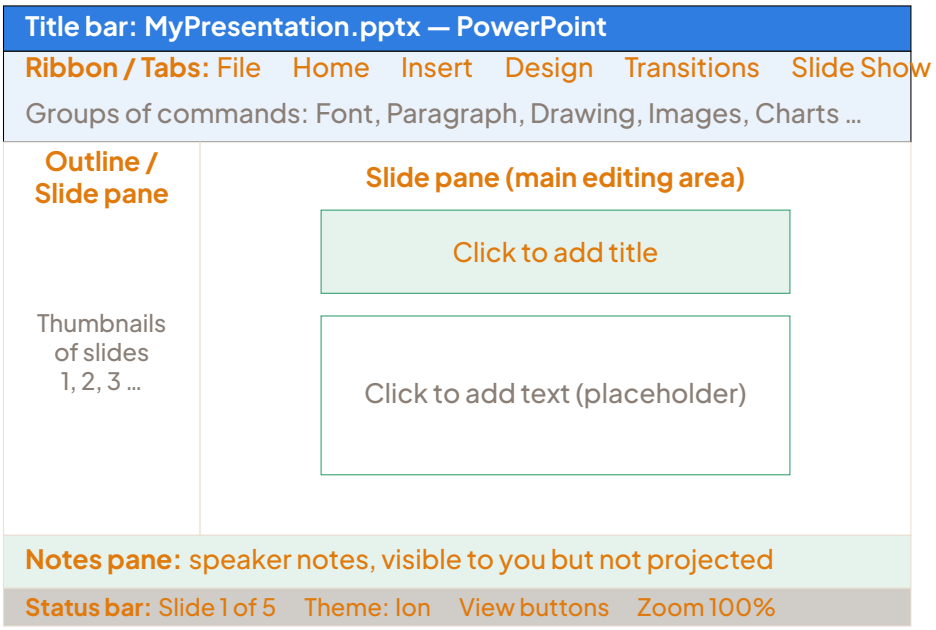
Software	Publisher / type	Remarks
Microsoft PowerPoint	Microsoft, commercial (Office 365)	The most widespread in Cameroonian schools and companies; files `.pptx`.
LibreOffice Impress	The Document Foundation, free and open source	Installed in many school computer rooms; native format `.odp`.
Google Slides	Google, free, web-based	Runs in a browser; ideal for group work and automatic online saving.
WPS Presentation	Kingsoft, free with premium options	Light, popular on laptops and phones; reads `.pptx`.

DID YOU KNOW? **Presentations in Cameroonian life**

Slide presentations are everywhere: teachers project lessons in multimedia rooms, Upper Sixth students defend their projects before a jury, start-ups in Douala's "Silicon Mountain" (Buea) pitch their ideas to investors, churches announce programmes between services, and ministries present budgets with projected charts. Mastering presentation software is a genuine employability skill.

1.2 Launching the Software and Touring the Interface

To launch PowerPoint, click the **Start** button, type PowerPoint and press **Enter** (in LibreOffice, open the Start Centre and choose Impress). Whatever the software, the working window is organised around the same zones.



The main zones of a presentation software window (PowerPoint / Impress).

KEY POINTS **Zones of the window**

- Title bar: name of the open file and of the application.
- Ribbon (or menus/toolbars in Impress): tabs such as Home, Insert, Design, Transitions, Slide Show, grouping all commands.
- Slide pane: the large central area where you edit the current slide.
- Outline / thumbnail pane (left): miniature views of all slides, used to select, move or

reorganise them.

- Notes pane (bottom): private speaker notes attached to each slide.
- Status bar and view buttons: slide number, theme, zoom, and quick access to Normal, Slide Sorter, Reading and Slide Show views.

1.3 Creating a New Presentation: Blank or Template

When the software opens, it offers two starting points:

- a **blank presentation**: white slides with no decoration — total freedom, but you must design everything yourself;
- a **template** or **design theme**: a ready-made set of colours, fonts, background and slide masters created by professionals.

METHOD **Creating a presentation with a theme**

1. Launch the software and choose New.
2. Select Blank presentation or click a template thumbnail.
3. If you started blank, open the Design tab and click a **theme**: every slide instantly receives the same colours, fonts and background.
4. Type the title and subtitle of the first slide, then save immediately (Ctrl+S).

WARNING **One theme, not five**

Applying different themes or random colours to each slide makes a presentation look amateurish. Choose one theme for the whole presentation; consistency is the first sign of professionalism.

1.4 Slides, Layouts and Placeholders

A **slide** is one screen of the presentation. A **placeholder** is a dotted box on a slide that "reserves a place" for a specific content: a title, a bulleted list, a picture, a chart or a table. You simply click it and type or insert.

DEFINITION **Slide layout**

A **slide layout** is a predefined arrangement of placeholders (title, text, content) on a slide. Examples: Title Slide, Title and Content, Two Content, Comparison, Blank.

Layout	Typical use
Title Slide	First slide: presentation title, your name, class, date.
Title and Content	The workhorse: a title plus one list, picture, table or chart.
Two Content	Compare two ideas, or place text beside an image.
Comparison	Side-by-side comparison with titles for each column.
Blank	Full freedom, e.g. for a large photo or a diagram.

To change the layout of an existing slide: **Home** → **Layout** → click the desired arrangement. The text already typed is kept and simply rearranged.

1.5 Managing Slides: Add, Duplicate, Move, Hide, Delete

All slide management happens in the left thumbnail pane or, better, in the **Slide Sorter view**, which displays all slides as a grid of miniatures — perfect for checking the logical flow of your story.

- **Add**: **Ctrl+M** or Home → New Slide; the new slide appears after the selected one.
- **Duplicate**: right-click a thumbnail → Duplicate Slide (useful to reuse a structure).
- **Move**: drag the thumbnail to its new position (in Normal or Slide Sorter view).
- **Hide**: right-click → Hide Slide; the slide stays in the file but is skipped during the show — handy for backup slides in a defence.
- **Delete**: select the thumbnail and press **Delete**.

EXEMPLE **Reorganising a defence presentation**

Manka'a prepares her project defence with slides in this order: Title, Results, Introduction, Method, Conclusion. In Slide Sorter view she notices the illogical order, drags Introduction to position 2 and Method to position 3, then hides a detailed calculations slide that she will show only if the jury asks. Her 8-slide story now flows naturally.

1.6 Entering and Formatting Text

Click a placeholder and type. Then select the text and use the **Home** tab to set:

- **Font**: choose a clear sans-serif font (Calibri, Arial); avoid fancy scripts that are hard to read from the back of a hall.
- **Size**: titles around 36–44 pt, body text at least 24 pt for projection.

- **Colour**: strong contrast with the background (dark text on light background or the reverse).
- **Alignment** and **bullets/numbering**: bullets for unordered ideas, numbers for steps or rankings.
- **Line spacing**: 1.15 or 1.5 for readability.

WARNING **The paragraph trap — apply the 6×6 rule**

The most common beginner's mistake is typing whole paragraphs on a slide. The audience then reads instead of listening, and the speaker is tempted to read the screen aloud. Apply the **6×6 rule**: about 6 lines per slide, 6 words per line. Put only keywords on the slide and speak the details — that is exactly what the notes pane is for.

1.7 Saving a Presentation: Formats and Compatibility

Save (**Ctrl+S**) updates the current file under its existing name; **Save As** (**F12**) creates a copy under a new name, location or format. Choose the format according to the purpose:

Format	Properties	When to use it
`.pptx`	Editable PowerPoint format; keeps animations and fonts if available.	Working file; presenting from a computer with PowerPoint.
`.odp`	OpenDocument Presentation, native to LibreOffice Impress.	Working file in free-software environments.
`.pdf`	Fixed layout: looks identical everywhere, but not editable and loses animations.	Sending by email/WhatsApp, printing handouts, guaranteeing the display.
`.ppsx`	PowerPoint Show: opens directly in Slide Show mode, not in edit mode.	Distributing a ready-to-present file that launches immediately.

WARNING **Exam tip (GCE)**

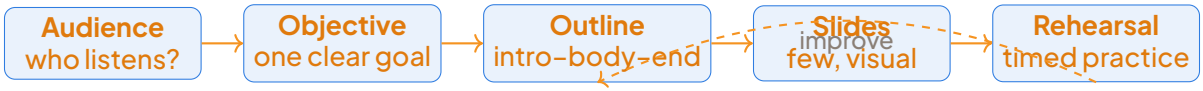
Know the difference between `.pptx` (editable, requires compatible software and fonts) and `.pdf` (fixed layout, readable on any device but not modifiable, animations lost). Use `.pptx` while producing and presenting; export to `.pdf` to distribute or print. Also remember: a `.pptx` opened in Impress may shift slightly — always test your file on the machine that will project it.

1.8 Planning Before Producing

Professional presenters spend more time planning than clicking. Before touching the software, answer: Who will listen? What must they remember? In what order?

METHOD **Planning a presentation in 5 steps**

1. Know your audience: parents, a jury, investors or classmates do not expect the same vocabulary, depth or tone.
2. State one clear objective: a single sentence, e.g. “convince the jury that our water-filter project is feasible”.
3. Build an outline: introduction (hook, plan), body (2–4 main ideas), conclusion (summary, call to action).
4. Limit the number of slides: roughly one slide per minute of speaking; a 10-minute defence needs about 8–12 slides, not 40.
5. Rehearse: present aloud, time yourself, adjust.



The presentation planning process: each step feeds the next, and rehearsal sends you back to improve the outline.

WORKED EXAMPLE 1 **Planning and producing a mini-presentation**

Statement. Your class must present “The importance of mobile money in Cameroon” in 5 minutes to new Lower Sixth students. (a) State the audience and one objective. (b) Propose an outline and a suitable number of slides. (c) Give the layout of slide 1 and of a body slide. (d) In which formats will you save, and why?

SOLUTION

Solution.

- (a) Audience: Lower Sixth students, beginners in ICT, so simple vocabulary and concrete examples (MTN MoMo, Orange Money). Objective: “Show that mobile money makes everyday payments faster and safer.”
- (b) Outline: Introduction (a market scene in Bamenda where a trader receives MoMo), Body (what mobile money is; advantages; precautions), Conclusion (summary + advice). At about one slide per minute: 6 slides — Title, Hook/photo, Definition, Advantages, Precautions, Conclusion.
- (c) Slide 1: Title Slide layout (title + names + class). A body slide such as “Advantages”: Title and Content layout with a bulleted list respecting the 6×6 rule, e.g. “Fast transfers

/ No need to travel / Available 24/7 / Secure PIN".

- (d) Save the working file as `.pptx` (editable, to keep improving it and to project it), then export a `.pdf` copy to share on the class WhatsApp group so that everyone sees the same fixed layout even without PowerPoint.

EXERCISE 1 **Your turn**

You must present your school to visiting students from another region in 8 minutes. (1) Define the audience and one objective. (2) Draw up an outline and state the ideal number of slides. (3) For each slide, indicate the layout you would choose. (4) Explain the difference between duplicating and hiding a slide, and give one situation where each is useful.

SOLUTION **Exercise**

(1) Audience: visiting students of your age — friendly tone, photos, little jargon. Objective: "Make visitors want to join our school." (2) Outline: Introduction (welcome, map), Body (history, results, clubs, facilities), Conclusion (invitation). About 8–10 slides. (3) Slide 1: Title Slide; welcome/map: Title and Content with picture; history: Title and Content (short bullets); clubs vs. results: Two Content to compare; final: Blank with a large group photo. (4) Duplicating creates an identical copy of a slide — useful to reuse a structure (e.g. one slide per club). Hiding keeps a slide in the file but skips it during projection — useful for a backup slide with extra statistics, shown only if a visitor asks a question.

KEY POINTS **Key points of Section 1**

- Presentation software (PowerPoint, Impress, Google Slides, WPS) produces a sequence of **slides** that support the speaker.
- Know the window: ribbon, slide pane, thumbnail pane, notes pane, status bar, view buttons.
- Choose one design theme; use **layouts** and **placeholders** instead of drawing text boxes everywhere.
- Manage slides (add, duplicate, move, hide, delete) in the thumbnail pane or Slide Sorter view.
- Respect the **6×6 rule**; put details in the speaker notes.
- Save as `.pptx` (editable) while working; export `.pdf` (fixed layout) to distribute; con-

sider `.ppsx` for direct show mode.

- Plan first: audience → objective → outline → slides → rehearsal.

2 SECTION 2: DESIGNING ATTRACTIVE AND CONSISTENT SLIDES

In Section 1 we learned how to open presentation software, create slides, choose layouts and type content. A slide deck that merely contains information, however, is not yet a good presentation. Think of two candidates presenting the same project on "Mobile Money in Cameroon" at a school science fair in Yaoundé: the first projects dense paragraphs in yellow text on a white background; the second shows a few large, well-aligned points in dark blue on white, with one clear picture per slide. Same content, completely different impact. This section teaches you the **design principles** and the software tools — themes, the **Slide Master**, pictures, shapes, tables, charts, headers and footers — that turn raw slides into an attractive, consistent and readable presentation.

2.1 Design Principles: Consistency, Contrast, Alignment, Proximity, Simplicity

Good slide design is not a matter of talent; it obeys a small number of rules that anyone can apply. Five principles, often summarised from graphic design theory, guide every decision you make on a slide.

DEFINITION **The five design principles**

- **Consistency**: the same fonts, colours, logo position and title style are used on every slide, so the audience recognises the presentation as one coherent document.
- **Contrast**: important elements (titles, key figures) stand out through differences in colour, size or weight; text must contrast strongly with its background.
- **Alignment**: every object is lined up with something else (titles on the same vertical line, bullet blocks starting at the same left edge). Nothing is placed at random.
- **Proximity**: related items are grouped close together; unrelated items are separated by space, so the eye immediately sees what belongs together.
- **Simplicity**: one idea per slide, few words, generous empty space. A slide supports the speaker; it does not replace the speech.

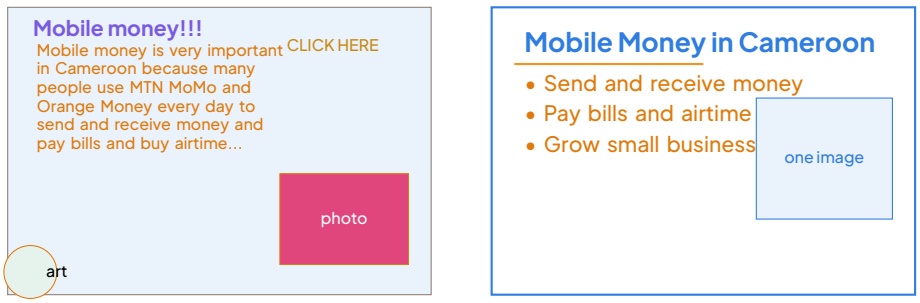
EXEMPLE **Choosing fonts and colours**

A student preparing a talk for the GCE ICT practical chooses:

- Fonts: one sans-serif font for titles (e.g. Calibri or Arial, bold) and the same family for body text — never more than two or three fonts in a whole presentation.
- Font sizes: titles at least 36–44 points, body text at least 24 points, so that text remains readable from the back of a classroom.
- Colours: a dark text colour (navy blue or black) on a light background (white or cream), plus one accent colour (e.g. orange) used only for emphasis.

WARNING **Common mistakes in design**

The most frequent errors are: using light text on a light background (yellow on white, light grey on beige); using more than three different fonts; and filling every centimetre of the slide with text and clip art. Remember that classroom projectors wash out low-contrast colours: what looks acceptable on your laptop screen can become invisible on the wall of a bright classroom in Buea or Bamenda. Always test with the projector if possible.



Cluttered: many fonts, low contrast, no alignment — Clean: strong contrast, aligned, one idea

A cluttered slide (left) versus a clean slide (right) respecting contrast, alignment and simplicity.

2.2 Themes, Variants and Background Styles

Applying the five principles slide by slide would be slow and error-prone. Presentation software solves this with **themes**.

DEFINITION **Theme and variant**

A **theme** is a coordinated set of colours, fonts and effects that is applied to the whole presentation at once (tab Design > Themes). A **variant** is an alternative colour or font combi-

nation within the same theme, offered in the Variants group of the Design tab.

METHOD **Applying a theme and changing the background**

1. Open the Design tab and click a theme thumbnail: all slides instantly adopt its colours and fonts.
2. In the Variants group, click a colour variant to switch, for example, from a blue to a green palette while keeping the same fonts.
3. To personalise further, click Format Background: choose a solid fill, gradient, picture or texture, then click Apply to All so that every slide shares the same background.

WARNING **Backgrounds and readability**

A busy background picture behind text destroys contrast. If you use a picture background, darken it or place a semi-transparent solid shape behind the text. When in doubt, a plain light background is always the safest choice for projection.

2.3 The Slide Master: One Change, Every Slide

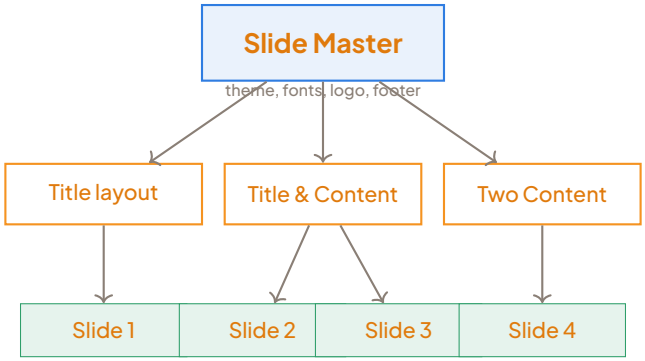
Suppose your school asks you to place its logo and the slide number on all 30 slides of your presentation. Copying and pasting the logo 30 times is slow, and if the logo changes you must redo everything. The correct tool is the **Slide Master**.

DEFINITION **Slide Master**

The **Slide Master** is the top-level slide that stores the theme, fonts, colours and objects (logo, footer, date, slide number) inherited by all the slides that use its **layouts**. It is opened from View > Slide Master.

PROPERTY **Inheritance from the Slide Master**

Any change made on the Slide Master — inserting a logo, setting the title font, adding a footer — automatically appears on every slide using that master. Similarly, a change made on a layout (e.g. the "Title and Content" layout) appears on all slides using that layout only. (The mechanism is examinable at the GCE; memorise the hierarchy Master → Layouts → Slides.)



Hierarchy of inheritance: formatting placed on the Slide Master flows down through the layouts to every slide.

METHOD **Adding a logo and slide number to all slides**

1. Click View > Slide Master.
2. Select the top (largest) master slide in the left pane.
3. Insert the logo (Insert > Pictures) and position it, e.g. bottom-right corner.
4. Use Insert > Header & Footer to tick Slide number and Date and time, then Apply to All.
5. Click Close Master View: the logo and numbers now appear on every slide.

EXEMPLE **GCE exam tip**

Exam questions very often ask: "How can the same logo (or slide number) be added to all the slides of a presentation at once?" The expected answer is: use the Slide Master (View > Slide Master), not copying the object onto each slide one by one. Copying is accepted only as a wrong-method contrast in your explanation.

2.4 Inserting and Formatting Pictures

Pictures make a slide attractive and memorable — a photo of a mobile money kiosk says more than a paragraph. Pictures can be inserted from a **file** on the computer (**Insert** > **Pictures** > **This Device**) or from **online sources** (Insert > Online Pictures / Stock Images).

Once inserted, a picture can be formatted with the **Picture Format** tab:

- **Cropping**: cutting away unwanted parts of the image to focus on the subject.
- **Resizing**: dragging a corner handle keeps the proportions; dragging a side handle distorts the image.

- **Borders and effects**: frames, shadows, reflections and soft edges from the Picture Styles gallery.
- **Compressing images**: **Picture Format** > **Compress Pictures** reduces file size (essential when the presentation must fit on a flash drive or be sent by email), at the cost of some quality.

WARNING **Stretching and copyright**

Never stretch a picture sideways: faces and objects become deformed. Always resize from a corner handle. Also, images taken from the Internet may be protected by copyright; for a school presentation, prefer the built-in stock images or free-image sites, and mention the source.

2.5 Shapes, Text Boxes, SmartArt and Icons

Beyond pictures, slides use drawn objects to explain ideas:

- **Shapes** (Insert > Shapes): arrows, rectangles, callouts — ideal for simple diagrams such as a flow of money between customer, agent and bank.
- **Text boxes** (Insert > Text Box): place text anywhere, outside the predefined placeholders.
- **SmartArt** (Insert > SmartArt): ready-made diagrams — lists, processes, cycles, hierarchies — that convert bullet points into an attractive graphic in one click.
- **Icons** (Insert > Icons): small standard symbols (phone, money, shield) that illustrate a point without a photo.

When several objects form one figure, select them all (hold **Shift** and click, or drag a selection box), then:

- **Group** (right-click > Group) so they move and resize as a single object;
- **Align** (Shape Format > Align) to line them up (Align Left, Align Top, Distribute Horizontally) — this is how the alignment principle is applied in practice.

EXPERIMENT **Guided practice: Building a process diagram with SmartArt**

Goal: Create a slide that explains the steps of an MTN Mobile Money cash withdrawal.

1. Insert a new slide with Title and Content layout. Title: “Withdrawing Cash via MTN MoMo”.
2. Click the SmartArt icon in the content placeholder, choose Process > Basic Chevron Process, click OK.
3. In the text pane, type the four steps: • Dial *150# • Select “Withdraw Cash” • Enter amount and agent code • Receive cash from agent.
4. With the SmartArt selected, use SmartArt Design > Change Colors to pick a colour

scheme matching your theme.

5. Use Format > Size to make the diagram large enough to be read from the back of the room.

Observation: The diagram stays perfectly aligned; if you add a step, the layout adjusts automatically.

2.6 Tables and Charts on a Slide

Numerical information is clearer as a table or a chart than as sentences.

DEFINITION **Table and chart on a slide**

A **table** organises data in rows and columns (Insert > Table); it is formatted with the Table Design tab (header shading, borders, banded rows). A **chart** (Insert > Chart) represents data graphically: column charts compare values, pie charts show proportions of a whole, line charts show evolution over time.

METHOD **Inserting a chart**

1. Click Insert > Chart.
2. Choose the type: column (comparison), pie (shares) or line (trend), then OK.
3. A small spreadsheet (data sheet) opens: replace the sample data with your own figures; the chart updates automatically.
4. Close the data sheet, then use the Chart Design and Format tabs to add a title, data labels and a legend.

PROPERTY **Linking chart data to a spreadsheet**

The chart on a slide is linked to its data sheet: editing a number in the sheet immediately updates the chart. A chart can also be linked to an external spreadsheet file, so that when the spreadsheet is updated, the presentation chart can be refreshed too (Paste Special > Paste Link when copying a chart from a spreadsheet).

WORKED EXAMPLE 2 **Choosing and building the right chart**

Statement. A Lower Sixth student surveyed how 40 classmates pay their canteen expenses: 22 use mobile money, 12 use cash, 6 use a bank card. State the most suitable chart type and describe how to insert it.

SOLUTION

Solution. The data are shares of a whole (the 40 students), so a pie chart is the most suitable type (a column chart would also be acceptable for comparison, but a line chart would be wrong: there is no time evolution). Steps: (1) Insert > Chart > Pie > OK. (2) In the data sheet that opens, enter the three categories — Mobile money 22, Cash 12, Bank card 6. (3) Close the sheet; the pie slices appear automatically in proportion. (4) Add data labels showing percentages (55%, 30%, 15%) and a title "Payment methods in the canteen". (5) Format with strong contrasting slice colours so the chart stays readable on a projector.

2.7 Headers, Footers, Slide Numbers and Speaker Notes

Professional slides carry small pieces of repeated information:

- **Header / Footer**: a line of text (e.g. the school name or presentation title) repeated on slides, set via **Insert > Header & Footer**.
- **Slide number**: automatic numbering, also from Header & Footer; it helps the audience refer to a slide during questions.
- **Date**: fixed or updated automatically each time the file is opened.

As seen above, placing these on the Slide Master guarantees they appear everywhere consistently.

DEFINITION **Speaker notes**

Speaker notes are private notes typed in the pane below the slide (or in View > Notes Page). They are visible to the presenter (in Presenter View or on printed notes pages) but not projected to the audience. They let the speaker keep the slide simple while remembering details, figures and examples.

EXEMPLE **Speaker notes in practice**

On a slide showing only the pie chart of canteen payments, the presenter types in the notes pane: "Explain that mobile money dominates because an MTN kiosk stands just in front of the school gate; mention that card payment requires a POS terminal the canteen

does not have." The slide stays clean; the speech stays rich.

2.8 Checking Readability Before Presenting

Before delivering the presentation, always perform a final readability check, ideally with the actual projector:

KEY POINTS **Readability checklist**

- Font sizes: titles ≥ 36 pt, body text ≥ 24 pt; if you must shrink text to fit, you have too much text.
- Contrast: dark text on light background (or the reverse); avoid red/green combinations and pale colours that projectors wash out in bright classrooms.
- Clutter: maximum about 6 lines of text per slide and 6 words per line (the "6 × 6" rule of thumb); one idea per slide.
- Consistency: same theme, same fonts, logo and slide numbers on every slide — check via the Slide Master.
- Proofreading: run the spelling checker and read each slide aloud once.

EXERCISE 2 **Designing a consistent presentation**

Your school asks you to prepare a 10-slide presentation on "The use of ICT in Cameroonian hospitals".

1. Explain how you would guarantee that the hospital logo, the slide number and the same fonts appear on all 10 slides without editing them one by one.
2. You have a table of the number of connected hospitals per region for the years 2021, 2022 and 2023. Which chart type best shows the evolution over time, and how do you insert it?
3. State two readability checks you would perform before projecting in a bright hall.

SOLUTION **Exercise 1**

1. Open View > Slide Master, select the top master, insert the logo and position it, set the title and body fonts, then use Insert > Header & Footer to tick Slide number and Apply to All. Every slide inherits these elements automatically.

2. A line chart (one line per region, years on the horizontal axis) best shows evolution over time. Insert it via Insert > Chart > Line, then type the years and values in the data sheet that opens; the chart updates automatically.
3. Check that body text is at least 24 pt and titles at least 36 pt, and that there is strong contrast (dark text on a light background), because projectors in bright rooms wash out pale colours; also remove any clutter so each slide carries one idea only.

DID YOU KNOW? **Did you know?**

In Cameroon, public services and companies such as CAMTEL, MTN and Orange use standardised presentation templates built on slide masters: the same logo, colours and footer appear on every slide of every official presentation. This is exactly the consistency principle — and it is why mastering the Slide Master is a real professional skill, not just an exam topic.

With well-designed, consistent and readable slides in hand, the next step is to bring them to life: Section 3 will add multimedia — sound, video — together with transitions between slides and animations of objects on a slide.

3 SECTION 3: MULTIMEDIA, TRANSITIONS AND ANIMATIONS

In the previous section we learned how to design visually consistent slides using themes, slide masters, and layout principles. A well-designed static slide is a solid foundation, but modern presentations often need to show processes, play media, and guide the audience's attention dynamically. This section introduces the tools that bring slides to life: multimedia insertion, slide transitions, object animations, and interactive navigation. Mastering these features will not only make your presentations more engaging but also earn you full marks in GCE practical tasks where examiners explicitly test the distinction between transitions and animations, the correct use of the Animation Pane, and the ability to create a self-running kiosk-style show.

3.1 Multimedia in Presentations

Modern presentation software (Microsoft PowerPoint, LibreOffice Impress, Google Slides) treats audio and video as first-class objects that can be placed on a slide just like an image. The most widely supported formats in the Cameroonian school and office environment are:

- **Audio:** MP3 (compressed, small size), WAV (uncompressed, high quality), and increasingly M4A/AAC.
- **Video:** MP4 with H.264 video codec and AAC audio — the de facto standard for compatibility across Windows, macOS, Linux, and mobile devices.

DEFINITION **Multimedia Object**

A multimedia object is an audio or video file embedded in or linked to a slide. When embedded, the file becomes part of the presentation package (larger file size, guaranteed playback). When linked, only the path is stored (smaller file, but the media file must travel with the presentation).

Inserting media.

Use `Insert $\to$ Media $\to$ Audio/Video $\to$ This Device...` (PowerPoint) or `Insert $\to$ Audio or Video` (Impress). The media appears as a speaker icon (audio) or a video frame (video) that you can resize and reposition.

Playback options.

Select the media object to reveal the `Playback` (or `Media Options`) tab. Key settings:

- **Start:** **Automatically** (plays as soon as the slide appears), **On Click** (waits for a mouse/key press), or **In Click Sequence** (part of the animation order).
- **Loop until Stopped:** repeats the media continuously — useful for background music on a title slide.
- **Trim Media:** lets you set start and end points without an external editor. Click `Trim`, drag the green/red markers, and confirm.
- **Fade In/Out:** adds smooth volume ramps.
- **Hide During Show:** (audio only) hides the speaker icon during the slide show.
- **Play Across Slides:** (audio only) continues playback across subsequent slides.

EXEMPLE **Adding a video clip to a slide about Mount Cameroon**

You are preparing a slide on tourism in the Southwest Region. You have a 2-minute MP4 clip of the Mount Cameroon Race of Hope. Insert the video, resize it to occupy the right half of the slide, set Start: On Click so you can introduce it verbally, and use Trim to keep only the 15-second summit sprint. Tick Hide While Not Playing if you want the frame invisible before playback.

WARNING **Common Mistake — Missing Media Files**

If you choose Link to File instead of Insert (embed), the video will not play on another computer unless you copy the media file into the same folder as the presentation. For GCE practical exams, always embed media unless the question explicitly asks for linking.

3.2 Recording Narration and Timings for a Self-Running Presentation

A **self-running presentation** (kiosk mode) advances automatically and includes a recorded voice-over. This is ideal for unattended displays at school open days, CAMTEL customer-care screens, or GCE practical submissions where the examiner watches the show without your live narration.

METHOD **Recording a narrated, self-running show**

1. Open the presentation and go to `Slide Show $\to$ Record Slide Show` (PowerPoint) or `Slide Show $\to$ Record` (Impress).
2. Choose `Record from Beginning`. A recording toolbar appears with `Record`, `Stop`, `Replay`, and navigation arrows.
3. Speak clearly into your microphone. Click `Next` (or press `Space`) to advance slides; the time spent on each slide is recorded as slide timings.
4. Use the `Pen` or `Highlighter` tools during recording to annotate slides — these strokes become part of the show.
5. Press `Stop` when finished. Save the file; the timings and narration are now embedded.
6. To enforce kiosk mode: `Slide Show $\to$ Set Up Slide Show $\to$ Browsed at a kiosk (full screen)`. The show will now loop until `Esc` is pressed.

EXPERIMENT **Guided Practice — Create a 3-Slide Auto-Advancing Show**

1. Create three slides: Title, "MTN Mobile Money Steps", "Orange Money Steps".
2. Insert a 5-second MP3 jingle on the title slide; set Start: Automatically, Loop until Stopped.
3. Record a 10-second narration on each content slide describing the USSD codes (*126# for MTN, *150# for Orange).
4. Set `Slide Show $\to$ Set Up Slide Show $\to$ Browsed at a kiosk.`
5. Press `F5` and verify the show runs unattended for 30 seconds, then loops.

3.3 Slide Transitions

DEFINITION **Transition**

A **transition** is the visual effect that plays when moving from one slide to the next. It be-

longs to the slide as a whole, not to individual objects.

Transitions are managed on the `Transitions` tab. Common built-in effects include:

- **Fade:** smooth cross-dissolve — professional and subtle.
- **Push:** new slide pushes the old one out — conveys progression.
- **Wipe:** a line sweeps across the screen — directional.
- **Morph:** (PowerPoint 2019+/365) automatically animates differences between two similar slides — powerful for object movement, resizing, and colour changes without manual animation.
- **Cut:** instantaneous change — no visual effect.

Configuring a transition.

Select one or more slides (Ctrl+Click for multiple, or Ctrl+A for all). Choose an effect from the gallery. Then adjust:

- **Effect Options:** direction (e.g., Push from Left, Right, Top, Bottom).
- **Duration:** how long the transition lasts (default 1.00 s; 0.50–1.50 s is typical).
- **Sound:** optional chime, whoosh, or custom WAV — use sparingly.
- **Advance Slide:**
  - **On Mouse Click** (default) — presenter controls pace.
  - **After:** 5 s (or any time) — slide advances automatically after the set delay. Combined with recorded timings, this creates a self-running show.

KEY POINTS **Transition Best Practices**

- Apply one consistent transition (e.g., Fade) to the whole presentation via `Apply to All`.
- Reserve distinct transitions for structural breaks (e.g., a Push when moving from "Problem" to "Solution").
- Keep Duration between 0.5 s and 1.5 s; longer transitions test the audience's patience.
- Avoid sounds unless the presentation runs unattended in a noisy environment (e.g., a trade fair booth at the Yaoundé Congress Centre).
- For GCE practicals, if the question says "apply a transition to all slides", use `Apply to All` after configuring the effect, duration, and advance settings.

WARNING **GCE Trap — Transition vs. Animation**

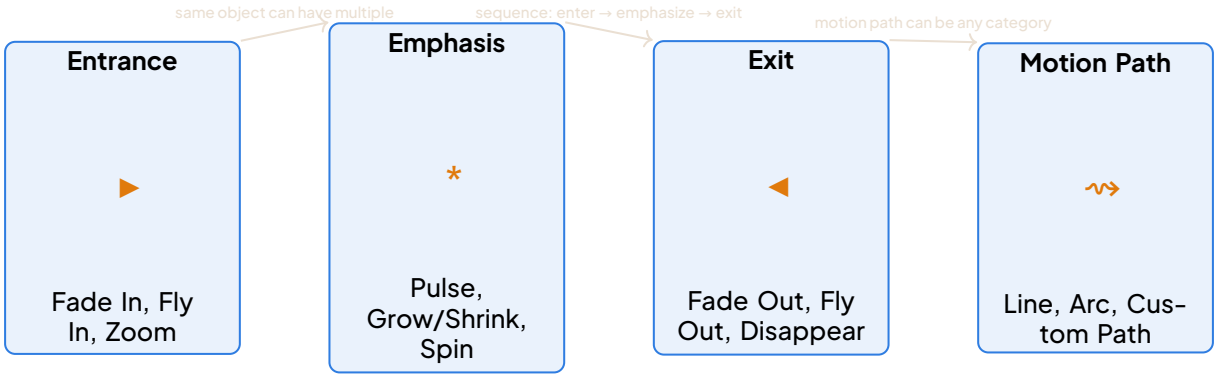
Examiners frequently ask: "State the difference between a slide transition and an animation." The correct answer: A transition occurs between slides; an animation occurs on objects within a slide. Confusing the two loses marks instantly.

3.4 Object Animations

DEFINITION **Animation**

An **animation** is a movement or effect applied to an individual object (text box, picture, shape, chart, SmartArt) within a single slide. It controls how the object appears, behaves, or disappears.

Animations are organised into four categories. The diagram below summarises them with a representative icon for each.



The four animation categories with a typical example icon. An object can receive multiple animations (e.g., Entrance → Emphasis → Exit).

Applying an animation.

Select the object → `Animations` tab → open the gallery (click the down arrow) → choose an effect. A small numbered tag appears next to the object indicating its order in the animation sequence.

Preview.

Click `Preview` on the Animations tab or press `Shift+F5` to start the show from the current slide.

EXEMPLE **Animating a photo of the Reunification Monument**

Insert a picture of the monument in Buea. Apply Entrance: Fade (duration 1 s). Then Add Animation → Emphasis: Grow/Shrink (1.5 s) to draw attention. Finally Add Animation → Exit: Fade (0.5 s) to clear the slide for the next point. The tags will show 1, 2, 3.

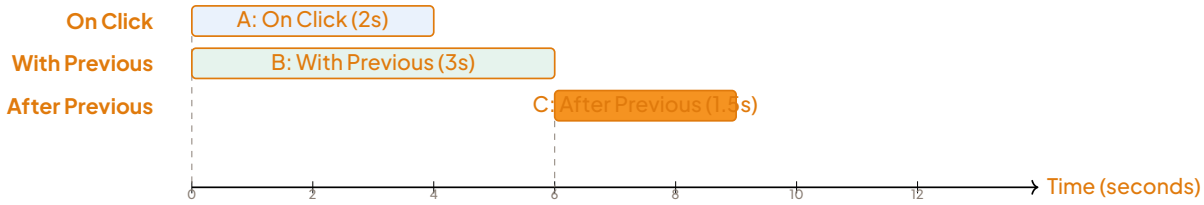
3.5 The Animation Pane and Sequencing

The **Animation Pane** (PowerPoint) or **Custom Animation** pane (Impress) is the control centre for fine-tuning animation behaviour. Open it via `Animations $\to$ Animation Pane`.

For each effect you can set:

- **Start:**
  - **On Click** — waits for the presenter's click (default).
  - **With Previous** — starts simultaneously with the previous effect in the list.
  - **After Previous** — starts automatically after the previous effect finishes.
- **Duration:** length of the effect in seconds (two decimals).
- **Delay:** pause before the effect starts (useful for staggering).
- **Reorder:** drag effects up/down or use the `Reorder Animation` arrows.
- **Effect Options:** direction, sequence (by paragraph, by series, by category, etc.), and other effect-specific settings.

The timeline below illustrates how `Start` options affect the sequence of three effects (A, B, C) on the same slide.



Animation timeline showing three effects with different start options. Effect A starts on click at t=0. Effect B starts with A (simultaneous). Effect C starts after B finishes (t=6 s).

METHOD **Animating a bulleted list progressively (progressive disclosure)**

1. Select the text box containing the bulleted list.
2. On the `Animations` tab, choose an Entrance effect (e.g., Fade or Appear).
3. Open the `Animation Pane`. The list appears as a single effect with a double-arrow icon indicating "grouped by paragraph".

4. Click the effect's drop-down arrow → Effect Options → Text Animation tab.
5. Set Group text: **By 1st Level Paragraphs** (or **By 2nd Level** for sub-bullets).
6. In the Animation Pane, each bullet now appears as a separate sub-effect. Set Start: On Click for each (default).
7. Preview: each click reveals the next bullet, keeping the audience focused on the current point.

EXEMPLE **Animating a column chart by series**

Insert a clustered column chart comparing MTN vs. Orange market share (2020–2023). Apply Entrance: Wipe (From Bottom). In `Effect Options $\to$ Chart Animation`, choose By Series. Each year's pair of columns appears together on click, allowing you to comment year by year.

EXEMPLE **Animating a SmartArt diagram**

Insert a `Process` SmartArt showing the steps of Mobile Money registration. Apply Entrance: Fade and set Effect Options → One by One. Each shape appears on click, letting you explain each step before revealing the next.

3.6 Hyperlinks and Action Buttons

Interactive presentations let the viewer (or presenter) jump to specific slides, external files, or web pages. This is essential for non-linear shows like a digital kiosk at the National Museum or a revision menu for GCE candidates.

Hyperlinks.

Select text, a shape, or an image → `Insert $\to$ Link` (or `Ctrl+K`). In the dialog:

- **Place in This Document:** choose a slide title (e.g., "Question 3").
- **Existing File or Web Page:** paste a URL (e.g., `https://www.antic.cm` for ANTIC's cybersecurity portal) or browse to a local PDF.
- **Email Address:** creates a `mailto:` link.
- **ScreenTip:** add a tooltip that appears on hover — good for accessibility.

Action Buttons.

`Insert $\to$ Shapes $\to$ Action Buttons` (bottom of the gallery). Draw the button on the slide; a dialog appears instantly to assign:

- **Hyperlink to:** Next Slide, Previous Slide, First Slide, Last Slide, Last Slide Viewed, Specific Slide, URL, Other File.
- **Run Program:** launch an external .exe (rarely used in exams).
- **Play Sound:** optional click feedback.
- **Mouse Over:** (in the Action Settings dialog) trigger on hover instead of click.

EXPERIMENT **Build an Interactive Revision Menu**

Create a slide titled "GCE ICT Revision". Add four Action Buttons labelled "Hardware", "Software", "Networks", "Databases". Hyperlink each to the corresponding section slide. On each section slide, place a small "Home" action button (House icon) linking back to the menu. Test in Slide Show mode: clicking jumps instantly without linear navigation.

3.7 Good Practice and Exam Tips

KEY POINTS **Design Principles for Transitions and Animations**

1. Substance over spectacle: Every effect should clarify the message. A Fade transition signals a new topic; a Motion Path shows a process flow (e.g., data moving from CPU to RAM).
2. Consistency: Use one transition style and one entrance animation family throughout.
3. Speed: Fast enough to feel responsive (0.5–1 s), slow enough to be perceived.
4. Sound: Only for self-running kiosks or accessibility cues; never for live presentations.
5. Accessibility: Avoid flashing effects (>3 Hz) that can trigger photosensitive epilepsy. Provide alternative text for animated charts.
6. Test on target hardware: A presentation that runs smoothly on a modern laptop may lag on an older school computer. Keep file sizes reasonable; compress media if needed (`File $\to$ Info $\to$ Media Size and Performance`).

WARNING **Common Mistake — Overloading with Effects**

Students often apply Spin, Bounce, and Sound to every bullet. Examiners penalise this as "distracting use of animations". In the GCE practical, if the marking scheme says "apply appropriate animations", a simple Fade or Appear on click scores full marks; a spinning, sound-emitting bullet may lose the "appropriateness" mark.

WARNING **Common Mistake — Forgetting to Embed Fonts**

If you use non-standard fonts (e.g., downloaded from the internet), the presentation may look different on the examiner's computer. Always `File $\to$ Options $\to$ Save $\to$ Embed fonts in the file` (PowerPoint) or ensure standard fonts (Arial, Calibri, Times New Roman) are used.

PROPERTY **GCE Exam Tip — Self-Running Show Setup**

To make a slideshow advance automatically without any clicks:

1. Go to `Transitions` tab.
2. Uncheck On Mouse Click, check After: and set a time (e.g., 10 s).
3. Click `Apply to All` (or set per slide).
4. Optionally, use `Slide Show $\to$ Rehearse Timings` to record exact durations per slide while practising your narration.
5. Finally, `Set Up Slide Show $\to$ Browsed at a kiosk (full screen).`

This is a frequent 3-mark practical question: "Configure the presentation to run automatically for a school open day display."

PROPERTY **GCE Exam Tip — Morph Transition**

The Morph transition (PowerPoint 2019/365) can replace dozens of manual animations. To show the growth of MTN Mobile Money agents from 2015 to 2023: duplicate the slide, resize and reposition the agent icons on the second slide, then apply Morph. PowerPoint automatically calculates the smooth movement. In written explanations, explicitly state "Morph transition" to earn the mark.

WORKED EXAMPLE 3 **GCE-Style Practical Question**

Task: You have a 5-slide presentation about "Cameroon's Digital Economy".

1. Apply a Fade transition to all slides with a duration of 1.00 s and set them to advance automatically after 8 s.
2. On slide 3, insert the video `digital_economy.mp4` (embedded). Set it to start Automatically and Loop until Stopped.
3. On slide 4, there is a bulleted list of four initiatives. Animate the list so each bullet ap-

pears On Click with a Fade entrance.

4. Create an Action Button on slide 1 labelled “Watch Video” that jumps directly to slide 3.

Solution:

1. `Transitions $\to$ Fade $\to$ Duration: 1.00 $\to$ Uncheck On Mouse Click $\to$ Check After: 00:08.00 $\to$ Apply to All.`
2. `Slide 3 $\to$ Insert $\to$ Video $\to$ This Device $\to$ digital_economy.mp4 $\to$ Insert. Playback $\to$ Start: Automatically $\to$ Loop until Stopped.`
3. `Slide 4 $\to$ Select list $\to$ Animations $\to$ Fade (Entrance). Animation Pane $\to$ Effect Options $\to$ Text Animation $\to$ Group text: By 1st Level Paragraphs. Verify each bullet shows Start: On Click.`
4. `Slide 1 $\to$ Insert $\to$ Shapes $\to$ Action Buttons: Custom (blank) $\to$ Draw button $\to$ Hyperlink to: Slide... $\to$ Slide 3 $\to$ OK. Type "Watch Video" inside the button.`

EXERCISE 3 **Practice Exercise**

1. Open a new presentation. Create a title slide “ICT in Cameroon” and three content slides: “Mobile Money”, “E-Government”, “Cybersecurity”.
2. Apply a Push transition (From Left) to all slides, duration 0.75 s, advance On Mouse Click.
3. On the “Mobile Money” slide, insert an audio file `mtm_jingle.mp3` (embedded). Set it to start Automatically and Hide During Show.
4. On the “E-Government” slide, add a clustered bar chart comparing 2021 vs 2022 online service usage. Animate the chart By Series with Wipe entrance.
5. On the “Cybersecurity” slide, create a bulleted list of three ANTIC recommendations. Animate the list progressively On Click using Appear.
6. Add a “Home” Action Button on each content slide linking back to the title slide.
7. Save, run the show (F5), and verify all navigation and animations work as intended.

SOLUTION **Exercise**

1. Standard slide creation.

2. Transitions $\to$ Push $\to$ Effect Options: From Left $\to$ Duration 0.75 $\to$ Apply to All.
3. Insert $\to$ Audio $\to$ This Device $\to$ mtm_jingle.mp3 $\to$ Playback $\to$ Start: Automatically $\to$ Hide During Show.
4. Insert $\to$ Chart $\to$ Clustered Bar $\to$ Edit data. Animations $\to$ Wipe $\to$ Effect Options $\to$ Chart Animation: By Series.
5. Select list $\to$ Animations $\to$ Appear $\to$ Animation Pane $\to$ Effect Options $\to$ By 1st Level Paragraphs.
6. Insert $\to$ Shapes $\to$ Action Buttons: Home $\to$ Draw $\to$ Hyperlink to: Slide 1 (Title). Copy to other slides.

DID YOU KNOW? **Did You Know? — Morph Transition in Cameroonian Classrooms**

The Morph transition (PowerPoint 2019/365) can replace dozens of manual animations. For example, to show the growth of MTN Mobile Money agents from 2015 to 2023, duplicate the slide, resize and reposition the agent icons on the second slide, then apply Morph. PowerPoint automatically calculates the smooth movement. This technique is a favourite in GCE practicals because it produces professional results with minimal effort — but remember to mention "Morph transition" in your written explanation to earn the mark.

With multimedia, transitions, animations, and hyperlinks mastered, you now have the complete toolkit to produce presentations that are not only attractive but also interactive, accessible, and examination-ready. The next section will cover delivering the presentation, printing handouts, and evaluating effectiveness — the final steps before you face the GCE board.

4 SECTION 4: DELIVERING, PRINTING AND EVALUATING THE PRESENTATION

In Section 3, you learnt how to enrich your slides with multimedia objects, transitions and animations. But a beautiful presentation that is badly delivered, badly printed or never rehearsed will fail its purpose. Imagine a candidate at the GCE practical examination who has prepared excellent slides about mobile money in Cameroon, but who does not know how to launch the slideshow, turns his back to the examiners and reads every word on the screen: all his technical work is wasted. In this final section, we learn how to **run** the slideshow professionally, how to **print** and **export** the presentation in the right format, and how to **evaluate** and **deliver** it like a confident speaker.

4.1 Running the Slideshow

DEFINITION **Slideshow**

A **slideshow** is the full-screen playback mode of a presentation, in which slides are displayed one after another to the audience, with their transitions, animations and multimedia content active.

Starting the show.

There are two essential ways to start a slideshow in Microsoft PowerPoint (and their equivalents exist in LibreOffice Impress):

- Press **F5** (or Slide Show → From Beginning): the show starts from the **first slide**. This is the normal way to present to an audience.
- Press **Shift+F5** (or Slide Show → From Current Slide): the show starts from the slide currently selected. This is very useful when you are testing a particular slide or resuming after an interruption.

Navigating during the show.

Once the show is running, you control it with the keyboard, the mouse or discreet on-screen tools:

Action	How to do it
Next slide / next animation	Enter, Space, Right arrow, Page Down, or left mouse click
Previous slide	Backspace, Left arrow, or Page Up
Jump to a specific slide	Type the slide number then Enter
End the show	Esc
On-screen tools	Move the mouse to the bottom-left corner: semi-transparent buttons appear (arrows, pen, menu)

WARNING **Trap: the mouse click advances everything**

A single left click triggers the next animation, not necessarily the next slide. If your slide has five animated bullet points, you must click five times before moving on. During a defence, candidates often panic, click too fast and skip content. Rehearse with the real file so that you know exactly how many clicks each slide requires.

4.2 Presenter Tools

Modern presentation software offers tools designed for the person speaking, not only for the audience.

Presenter view.

When the computer is connected to a projector, **Presenter View** shows two different screens: the audience sees only the current slide, while the speaker sees the current slide, the next slide, the speaker notes and a timer. This is the professional way to present: you always know what is coming and you never lose your timing.

Pen and highlighter during the show.

During the show, press **Ctrl+P** to activate the pen (or use the on-screen pen button). You can then circle a figure, underline a keyword or draw an arrow directly on the slide, exactly as a teacher does on the board. The highlighter emphasises text with a transparent colour. When you end the show, the software asks whether you want to keep or discard these annotations.

Black or white screen.

Press **B** to turn the screen black, or **W** to turn it white, at any moment. Press the same key again to return to the slide. This is precious when you want the audience's full attention on you and not on the screen, for example while answering a delicate question.

Zooming into a slide.

In recent versions, you can zoom into a region of a slide during the show (on-screen magnifier tool or dedicated zoom slides) to make small details readable, for instance the figures of a budget table.

4.3 Rehearsing Timings and Recording the Show

METHOD **Rehearsing timings**

To prepare an automatic or perfectly timed presentation:

1. Open the presentation and go to the Slide Show tab.
2. Click **Rehearse Timings**. The show starts full screen and a small timer toolbar appears.
3. Advance through the show exactly as you would in front of the audience, clicking when each animation or slide should appear. The timer records the duration of each slide.
4. At the end, the software displays the total time and asks whether you want to save the timings. Click Yes.
5. The saved timings now appear in the Slide Sorter view under each slide, and the show can play automatically without any click.

Automatic and kiosk playback.

Once timings are saved, use Set Up Slide Show to choose the playback mode. The **kiosk mode** (Browsed at a kiosk) loops the presentation continuously and ignores most keyboard input: only Esc stops it. This is ideal for an information screen at an exhibition, a school open day or a company reception hall in Douala or Yaoundé.

Recording the slideshow.

You can also Record Slide Show to capture your voice narration together with the timings and

laser-pointer movements. The result can be replayed later or exported as a video, which is useful for distance learning or for a teacher who wants students to revise a lesson at home.

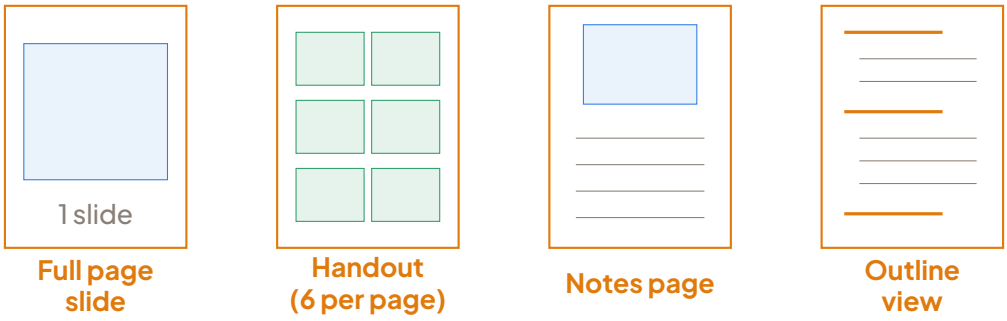
4.4 Printing the Presentation

Printing a presentation is not only printing slides. PowerPoint offers four **print layouts**, each with a precise purpose.

DEFINITION **Handout**

A **handout** is a printed version of the presentation with several slides per page (typically 2, 3, 4, 6 or 9), given to the audience so that they can follow the talk and take notes without copying the slides.

- **Full page slides**: one slide per page. Used for archiving or for slides that must be read in detail.
- **Handouts**: 2, 3, 4, 6 or 9 slides per page. The 3-slides layout prints lines next to each slide for handwritten notes — the favourite for teachers and examiners.
- **Notes pages**: one slide per page with the speaker notes printed below it. Perfect for the speaker's own preparation.
- **Outline view**: prints only the text (titles and bullet points), without images. Ideal for a quick, cheap review of the content and structure.



The four print layouts: full page slide, handout (6 slides per page), notes page and outline view.

Print range and colour.

In the Print dialog you also choose:

- the **print range**: all slides, the current slide, or a custom range such as slides 3–7;
- the **colour mode**: colour, grayscale or pure black and white. Grayscale saves expensive colour ink and often prints more clearly on school printers;
- the number of copies and collation.

EXEMPLE **Choosing the right layout**

For her defence on "The impact of mobile money in Cameroon", Ngong prints: (a) handouts with 3 slides per page for the jury, so they can annotate; (b) notes pages for herself, to rehearse; (c) the outline for her supervisor to check the logic quickly. She prints the jury's handouts in grayscale because the school printer's colour cartridge is nearly empty.

4.5 Exporting and Packaging the Presentation

Printing is not always the best way to share a presentation. Exporting creates a file that anyone can open.

PROPERTY **PDF export preserves the layout**

Exporting a presentation to **PDF** preserves the fonts, the layout and the placement of images and media on any computer, even one where the presentation software is not installed. Each slide becomes one page of the PDF document.

Other export formats.

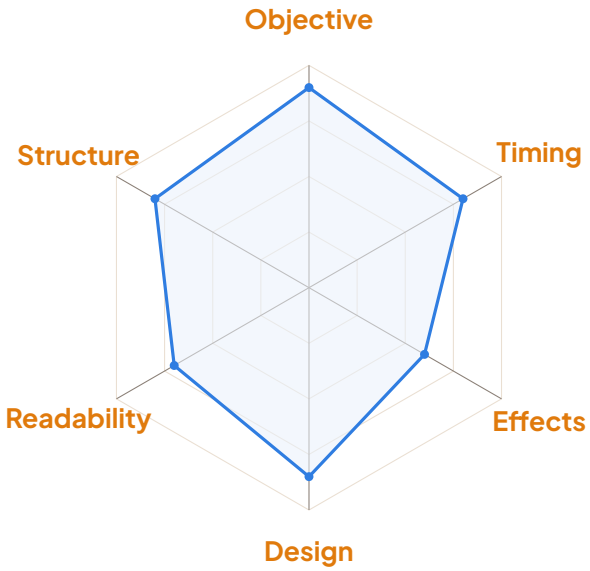
- **Video** (`.mp4`): the slideshow, with its timings, animations and narration, becomes a video file that plays on phones, televisions and social media.
- **Images**: each slide can be saved as a `.png` or `.jpeg` picture, useful for posting a slide on WhatsApp or inserting it into a report.
- **Package for CD / media packaging**: this command copies the presentation together with its linked media files (videos, sounds) and fonts into a single folder, so that nothing is missing when the file is opened on another computer.

WARNING **The missing-video trap**

A video inserted as a link is not stored inside the `.pptx` file. If you copy only the presentation to a USB flash drive and present on another computer, the video will not play. Always embed media or use the packaging feature, and always test the file on the actual presentation computer before the defence.

4.6 Evaluating a Presentation: the Quality Checklist

Before delivering, evaluate your work against six criteria. A good presentation has: a **clear objective**, a **logical structure**, **readable slides**, a **consistent design**, **moderate effects** and a **respected timing**.



Each axis is scored from 0 (centre) to 5 (outer ring).

Radar diagram of the six quality criteria. Here the presentation is strong on objective and design but weaker on effects (too many animations) and readability.

WORKED EXAMPLE 4 **Evaluating and improving a presentation**

Marcel has prepared 20 slides for a 5-minute talk. His slides use four different fonts, light yellow text on a white background, a different transition on every slide, and he has never rehearsed. Evaluate his presentation with the checklist and propose corrections.

SOLUTION

Solution. Apply the six criteria:

1. Clear objective: acceptable if the topic is focused, but 20 slides in 5 minutes means about 15 seconds per slide — impossible. Correction: reduce to 6–8 slides.
2. Logical structure: to verify; impose the classic plan introduction – development – conclusion, one idea per slide.
3. Readable slides: light yellow on white fails the contrast rule. Correction: dark text on a light background (or the reverse), font size at least 24 points.
4. Consistent design: four fonts break consistency. Correction: apply one theme with at most two fonts via the Slide Master.
5. Moderate effects: a different transition per slide distracts the audience. Correction: keep one simple transition (e.g. Fade) for the whole show.

6. Respected timing: never rehearsed. Correction: use Rehearse Timings and adjust until the show fits within 5 minutes.

After these corrections, Marcel's radar diagram becomes balanced, and his defence becomes credible.

4.7 Delivery Skills

The best slides in the world cannot save a poor speaker. Delivery is a skill, and it is assessed in defences and in the GCE practical context.

WARNING **Common mistake: reading the slides**

The most frequent and most penalised mistake is reading the slides word for word with your back to the audience. The slides support the speaker; they do not replace him. The audience can read faster than you can speak: if you simply read, you add nothing and you lose eye contact, credibility and marks.

METHOD **Delivering like a professional**

1. Face the audience, not the screen. Glance at the slide, then speak to the people.
2. Do not read: use the slides as visual support and your notes pages for details.
3. Manage time: rehearse, watch the presenter-view timer, and know which slide you can skip if you are late.
4. Speak clearly and slowly, especially at the beginning when stress is highest.
5. Handle questions: listen fully, thank the questioner, answer briefly; if you do not know, say so honestly and promise to find out. Use the **B** key to blank the screen during a long discussion.

DID YOU KNOW? **Did you know?**

In Cameroon, the same delivery skills are expected everywhere: a student defending a project at the GCE, a nurse presenting a vaccination campaign in a health district, or a start-up pitching a mobile application to investors in Bonanjo all follow the same rule — the person convinces, the slides illustrate.

4.8 Integration Activity

EXPERIMENT **Producing and defending a complete presentation**

In teams of three, produce and defend a complete multimedia presentation on an authentic topic, for example: “The role of ANTIC in securing digital services in Cameroon”, “Mobile money and financial inclusion in our town”, or “The responsible use of social networks by students”.

1. Define the objective and the plan (introduction, three parts, conclusion).
2. Build 8 to 10 slides using a Slide Master for consistency; insert at least one image, one chart and one short sound or video.
3. Apply one transition to the whole show and simple entrance animations to key points.
4. Rehearse the timings until the show fits the allowed 7 minutes; save the timings.
5. Export a PDF copy and package the media on a USB flash drive.
6. Print 3-slides-per-page handouts for the jury.
7. Defend the presentation: one member presents, another handles questions, the third manages the computer. The class evaluates the defence using the six-criteria checklist and the radar diagram.

EXERCISE 4 **GCE-style practice**

1. Give the keyboard shortcut to start a slideshow from the beginning, and the key to end it.
2. A teacher wants to give each student a printed sheet with 6 slides and room for notes. Which print layout should he choose, and in which menu?
3. Explain two advantages of exporting a presentation to PDF before sending it by e-mail.
4. During a show, which key turns the screen black, and why is this useful when answering questions?

SOLUTION **Exercise 1**

1. **F5** starts the show from the beginning; **Esc** ends it.

2. He chooses the Handouts layout with 6 slides per page (or 3 for ruled note lines), in File → Print, under the layout settings.
3. PDF preserves fonts, layout and media placement on any computer, and the recipient does not need the presentation software installed; the file is also harder to modify accidentally.
4. The **B** key turns the screen black. It removes the visual distraction so the audience concentrates on the speaker during the discussion; pressing B again restores the slide.

KEY POINTS **Exam tip — GCE practical**

Memorise the essential shortcuts: **F5** (start show from the beginning), **Shift+F5** (from current slide), **Esc** (end show), **B**/**W** (black/white screen), **Ctrl+P** (pen). Know how to print handouts with a chosen number of slides per page and how to export to PDF: these are among the most frequent practical exam tasks. And never forget during a defence: face the jury, speak, and let the slides support you.

5 INTEGRATION ACTIVITY

6 DELIVERING, PRINTING AND EVALUATING THE PRESENTATION

6.1 Aims of the activity

This integration activity is designed to consolidate all competencies acquired in Lessons 65, 66 and 67. By the end of this activity, you must be able to:

- **Plan** a presentation project: analyse the audience, define a clear communication objective, structure a logical outline and validate it with a storyboard.
- **Implement** a consistent visual identity using the **Slide Master**: apply a custom theme, insert a persistent logo, configure footers with automatic slide numbering and date, and define master layouts for title, content and section header slides.
- **Produce** professional slides: manipulate text boxes, bulleted lists, **SmartArt** graphics, tables and charts (linked to a data source) while respecting readability rules (contrast, font size, alignment, 6×6 rule).
- **Integrate multimedia** elements purposefully: insert and trim a local video clip or audio narration, set playback options (automatic/on click, loop, hide while not playing) and compress media to manage file size.
- **Apply transitions and animations** with moderation: choose a single, subtle transition scheme for the whole deck; apply progressive entrance animations to lists and objects; use the **Animation Pane** to sequence effects (Start: On Click / After Previous) and adjust timings.
- **Prepare delivery**: rehearse with the **Rehearse Timings** tool, create speaker notes, configure **Presenter View** for dual-screen support, and set up a kiosk or speaker-led show type.
- **Export and print** professional outputs: print 3-slides-per-page handouts with note lines, export a high-fidelity **PDF** for distribution, and package the presentation for CD/USB (**Package Presentation for CD**).
- **Evaluate** a presentation critically using a standardised checklist covering structure, visual design, content accuracy, technical execution and oral delivery.

6.2 Situation

Context: The Government Bilingual High School (GBHS) Mbankomo has been invited to showcase its achievements at the National Education Open Days (Journées Portes Ouvertes de l'Éducation) organised by MINEDUB at the Palais des Congrès in **Yaoundé**, next month. The Principal, Mr. Fonkou, will man the school's stand and meet prospective parents, sponsors (local businesses, NGOs) and educational partners.

Problem: The Principal needs a **10-slide multimedia presentation** that runs automatically on a

loop at the stand (kiosk mode) but can also be delivered live in 5 minutes during a scheduled slot on the main stage. The presentation must convince the audience that GBHS Mbankomo is the school of choice for academic excellence, holistic development and modern facilities.

Constraints and Requirements:

1. **Teamwork:** Work in groups of **three students** (roles: Project Manager/Designer, Content Researcher/Data Analyst, Multimedia Technician/Presenter).
2. **Audience:** Parents (Francophone/Anglophone), Sponsors (MTN Foundation, Orange Cameroon, local entrepreneurs), MINEDUB inspectors.
3. **Objective:** Inform about results and facilities, Persuade to enrol/partner, Reassure on discipline and values.
4. **Length:** Exactly **10 slides** (including title and closing slides). Live delivery: **5 minutes** maximum.
5. **Mandatory Content Elements:**
   - At least **one original photo** of the school (building, lab, library, or sports field).
   - One **Clustered Column Chart** showing GCE Advanced Level pass rates (% pass) for the last three sessions (2022, 2023, 2024) for both Arts and Science series.
   - One **Table** summarising the **Annual School Fees Structure** (Tuition, PTA, Uniform, Lab/Computer fees) for Form 1 to Upper Sixth.
   - One **multimedia clip**: either a 30–second **video** (school choir, lab experiment, sports action) or an **audio narration** of the Principal's welcome message (recorded via smartphone/PC microphone).
6. **Technical Specifications:**
   - **Slide Master:** Custom theme (school colours: Navy Blue #002B5C and Gold #C5962C), School Logo top-right, Footer with "GBHS Mbankomo | Yaoundé Open Days 2025 | Slide #" and automatic date.
   - **Transitions:** One uniform transition applied to All Slides (e.g., **Fade** or **Push**, Duration 1.00s). No sound on transition.
   - **Animations:** Progressive entrance (e.g., **Appear** or **Wipe**) for all bulleted lists (By Paragraph: Level 1). Charts/Table: By Series/Category. Entrance only; no Emphasis or Exit effects.
   - **Rehearsal:** Timings recorded via **Rehearse Timings**. Total show ≤ 5:00 min.
   - **Outputs:** (a) Print **Handouts (3 slides/page)** with lines for notes. (b) Export **PDF** (Standard quality). (c) **Package for CD/USB** (linked media included).
7. **Defense & Evaluation:** Each team presents live (5 min) to the class. Peers evaluate using the **Peer Evaluation Checklist** (provided below). The teacher validates the best presentation for the Principal.

6.3 Tasks

Phase 1: Planning & Storyboarding (Paper-based, 30 min)

1. **Audience & Objective Analysis:** Write a 3-sentence **Communication Objective** (SMART: Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound). Identify 3 key concerns of the Parents and 2 of the Sponsors.
2. **Outline & Storyboard:** On A4 paper, sketch a 10-slide storyboard. For each slide: (a) Slide Title, (b) Layout type (Title, Title+Content, Two Content, Section Header, Blank), (c) Key message (max 6 words), (d) Visual/Multimedia element planned, (e) Speaker notes prompt. Get teacher **approval signature** before touching the computer.

Phase 2: Slide Master & Theme Construction (20 min)

3. Open a blank presentation. Go to `View > Slide Master`.
4. **Theme Colours:** `Slide Master > Background > Colours > Customize Colours`. Set: Text/Background Dark 1 = Navy #002B5C; Accent 1 = Gold #C5962C; Accent 2 = White #FFFFFF; Hyperlink = Gold. Save as `GBHS_Theme`.
5. **Fonts:** `Fonts > Customize Fonts`. Heading: `Calibri Light (Headings)`; Body: `Calibri (Body)`.
6. **Master Layout (Top Master):** Insert school logo (top-right, height 1.2 cm). Insert `Footer` placeholder: Left: `GBHS Mbankomo | Yaoundé Open Days 2025`; Center: `Date (Fixed: 15 March 2025)`; Right: `Slide #`. Apply `Gold` font colour to footer text. Untick `Title Slide` footer if desired.
7. **Custom Layouts:** Duplicate `Title and Content` layout → Rename `Chart_Layout`. Add a placeholder `Content > Chart` on right, text on left. Duplicate for `Table_Layout`. Close Master View.

Phase 3: Slide Development & Content Population (60 min)

8. **Slide 1 (Title Layout):** "GBHS Mbankomo: Excellence in Bilingual Education". Subtitle: "Yaoundé Open Days 2025 | Preparing Global Citizens". Background: Full-bleed school gate photo (send to back).
9. **Slide 2 (Section Header):** "Our Vision & Mission". Body: 3 bullets (Vision, Mission, Core Values).
10. **Slide 3 (Title + Content + Photo):** "Modern Facilities for 21st Century Learning". Left: 4 bullets (Science Labs, ICT Centre, Library, Sports Complex). Right: Insert school photo (lab or library). Apply **Picture Format > Corrections > Sharpen/Soften** if needed.
11. **Slide 4 (Chart_Layout):** "GCE A/L Pass Rates: 3-Year Trend (2022-2024)". Insert Clustered Column Chart. **Data:** See Model Answer. Chart Title: "Pass Rate %". Legend: Bottom. Data Labels: Outside End. Style: Style 8 (Gold columns on Navy).
12. **Slide 5 (Table_Layout):** "Affordable Fee Structure 2024/2025". Insert Table (6 rows × 5 cols). Header Row: Class, Tuition (FCFA), PTA (FCFA), Uniform (FCFA), Total (FCFA). Fill realistic data (see Model). Apply `Table Style Medium 2` (Gold header). Set `Layout > AutoFit > Fixed Column Width`.
13. **Slide 6 (Two Content):** "Co-Curricular Excellence". Left: SmartArt `Vertical Box List` (Clubs: Robotics, Debate, Environment, Journalism). Right: Photo collage (3 pics grouped) or icons.
14. **Slide 7 (Title + Content):** "Strategic Partnerships". Logos of MTN Foundation, Orange Cameroon,

MINEDUB, Local Council (Insert > Pictures > This Device). Align horizontally, distribute horizontally.

15. **Slide 8 (Blank Layout + Multimedia):** "Hear from Our Community". Insert **Video** (from file: `choir_performance.mp4`) OR **Audio** (from file: `principal_welcome.m4a`). **Playback:** Start `Automatically` (kiosk) / `On Click` (live). Check `Loop until Stopped` (kiosk only). `Video Format > Poster Frame` set to a nice frame.

16. **Slide 9 (Title + Content):** "Admissions Open for 2025/2026". Bullets: Entry classes, Requirements, Deadline, Contact (Phone/WhatsApp: +237 6XX XX XX XX, Email: admissions@gbhsmbank Icon for phone/email.

17. **Slide 10 (Title Only / Closing):** "Thank You / Merci / Mèsi". School Logo large centre. "Visit our Stand #B12". QR Code image linking to school website (generated online).

Phase 4: Transitions, Animations & Timings (30 min)

18. **Transitions:** `Transitions > Fade` (or Push). `Effect Options: Through Black` (if Fade) / `From Right` (if Push). Duration: `1.00 s`. `Apply To All`. Uncheck `On Mouse Click` (for kiosk); Check `After: 00:00.00` (will be overwritten by rehearsal).

19. **Animations:** Select Slide 2 content placeholder → `Animations > Appear`. `Effect Options > By Paragraph`. Open `Animation Pane`. Select all list animations → `Start: After Previous`. Delay: `0.20 s`. Repeat for Slides 3, 4 (Chart: By Series), 5 (Table: By Row), 6, 7, 9. **Remove** all animations from Slide 1 and 10.

20. **Rehearse Timings:** `Slide Show > Rehearse Timings`. Deliver script naturally. Pause on Slide 8 for video/audio to play fully. Save timings. Verify total ≤ 5:00 min in `Slide Sorter` view.

21. **Set Up Show:** `Slide Show > Set Up Slide Show`. Choose `Browsed at a kiosk (full screen)` for stand version; `Presented by a speaker (full screen)` for live version. Save two copies if needed: `GBHS_Kiosk.pptx` and `GBHS_Live.pptx`.

Phase 5: Outputs, Packaging & Defense (20 min)

22. **Handouts:** `File > Print > Settings > Full Page Slides > Handouts > 3 Slides`. Check `Frame Slides`, `Print Comments` (if any), `Print Hidden Slides` (off). Print to PDF or Paper.

23. **Export PDF:** `File > Export > Create PDF/XPS Document > Create PDF/XPS`. Options: `Standard (publishing online and printing)`. Publish.

24. **Package for CD:** `File > Export > Package Presentation for CD > Package for CD`. Name: `GBHS_OpenDays_Package`. Ensure `Linked files` included. Copy to USB.

25. **Live Defense:** Team presents (5 min). Class evaluates using Checklist. Teacher moderates.

6.4 Model answer

1. Planning Artefacts (Sample)

Element	Description
Communication Objective	By the end of the 5-minute presentation, 80% of visiting parents at the Yaoundé Open Days will be able to cite three distinct academic or infrastructural strengths of GBHS Mbankomo and request an admission form or scan the QR code for more information.
Parent Concerns	1. Academic results (GCE pass rates). 2. Discipline & moral values. 3. Cost/Value for money (fees vs facilities).
Sponsor Concerns	1. Visibility/ROI (branding on stand, uniforms). 2. Impact metrics (students reached, STEM labs equipped).

Storyboard Outline (Approved by Teacher: _____ Date: _____)

#	Title	Layout	Key Message	Visual	Notes Prompt
1	GBHS Mbankomo: Excellence...	Title	Brand identity	School Gate Photo (Full bleed)	"Welcome, I am [Name]..."
2	Our Vision & Mission	Section Header	Guiding principles	None (Clean)	"Three pillars..."
3	Modern Facilities	Title+Content+Pic	Conducive environment	Lab Photo (Right)	"We invested 50M FCFA..."
4	GCE Results 2022–2024	Chart_Layout	Consistent excellence	Clustered Column Chart	"Science 92%, Arts 88%..."
5	Fee Structure	Table_Layout	Transparent, affordable	Fees Table	"All-inclusive, no hidden costs"
6	Co-Curricular Life	Two Content	Holistic development	Smartart + Icons	"Robotics won Regionals..."
7	Partnerships	Title+Content	Trusted by leaders	Partner Logos	"MTN equipped ICT Lab..."
8	Community Voices	Blank + Media	Authentic testimony	Video/Audio Clip	"Play video... pause for effect"
9	Admissions 2025/26	Title+Content	Call to Action	Icons (Phone, Email, QR)	"Forms available at Stand B12"
10	Thank You	Title Only	Lasting impression	Logo + QR Code	"Questions? Visit Stand B12"

2. Slide Master Configuration Details

- **Colour Palette (RGB):** Navy `0, 43, 92` (#002B5C); Gold `197, 150, 44` (#C5962C); White `255, 255, 255`; Light Grey `230, 230, 230` (for table alt rows).
- **Footer Text Boxes (Master):** Left: `GBHS Mbankomo | Yaoundé Open Days 2025` (Font: Calibri 10 pt, Gold, Left Align). Center: `15 March 2025` (Fixed date). Right: `Slide #` (Slide Number placeholder, Gold).
- **Logo Placement:** Top Master → `Insert > Pictures > Logo.png` → Position: Horizontal Alignment: Right, Vertical: Top. Margin: 0.5 cm. `Lock Aspect Ratio`.

3. Slide 4 – Chart Data (Source: School Archives, verified by Principal)

Session	Arts Series (% Pass)	Science Series (% Pass)
2022	78	85
2023	82	89
2024	88	92

Chart Construction: Insert → Chart → Clustered Column. Paste data above. **Chart Elements:** Axes (Primary Vertical: 0–100%, Major Gridlines off), Chart Title: "GCE A/L Pass Rate Trend (2022–2024)", Legend: Bottom. **Format Data Series:** Arts → Fill: Gold (#C5962C); Science → Fill: Navy (#002B5C). Gap Width: 100%. Data Labels: Value, Outside End, Font: Calibri 10 pt, Bold, Navy.

4. Slide 5 – Fee Structure Table (Sample Data FCFA)

Class	Tuition	PTA Levy	Uniform (Set)	Total Annual
Form 1 – 2	120,000	15,000	25,000	160,000
Form 3 – 4	130,000	15,000	25,000	170,000
Form 5	140,000	15,000	25,000	180,000
Lower Sixth (Arts)	150,000	20,000	30,000	200,000
Lower Sixth (Science)	160,000	20,000	30,000	210,000
Upper Sixth (Arts)	155,000	20,000	0*	175,000
Upper Sixth (Science)	165,000	20,000	0*	185,000

* Uniform purchased in Lower Sixth. **Table Style:** Medium 2 (Gold Header, Banded Rows). **Animation:** `Animations > Wipe > Effect Options: From Left > By Row`. Start: After Previous, Delay 0.15s.

5. Slide 8 – Multimedia Configuration

- **Video File:** `choir_performance.mp4` (H.264/MP4, 720p, 28 sec, 12 MB). Inserted via `Insert > Media > Video > This Device`.
- **Playback Tab Settings (Kiosk Version):** `Start: Automatically; Play Full Screen: Checked; Hide While Not Playing: Checked; Loop until Stopped: Checked; Rewind after Playing: Checked`.
- **Playback Tab Settings (Live Version):** `Start: On Click; Loop until Stopped: Unchecked`.

- **Poster Frame:** Scrub to 00:05 (choir smiling) → `Video Format > Poster Frame > Current Frame`.
- **Compression:** `File > Info > Media Size and Performance > Compress Media > HD (720p)`. Target final .pptx < 50 MB.

6. Animation Pane Configuration (Representative Sample for Slide 4 Chart)

Order	Object	Effect	Start	Duration / Delay
1	Chart Title	Appear	After Previous	0.50s / 0.00s
2	Chart Area (Background)	Fade	After Previous	0.50s / 0.00s
3	Series "Arts" (3 columns)	Wipe (From Bottom)	After Previous	0.50s / 0.20s
4	Series "Science" (3 columns)	Wipe (From Bottom)	After Previous	0.50s / 0.20s
5	Legend	Fade	After Previous	0.30s / 0.00s

Note: All text placeholders on content slides use `Appear > By Paragraph (Level 1) > Start: After Previous > Delay: 0.20s`. No animations on Slide 1 (Title) and Slide 10 (Closing).

7. Rehearsal Timings Log (Target: 5:00 min = 300 sec)

Slide	Content	Elapsed (mm:ss)	Notes
1	Title	0:00 – 0:15	Walk to centre, smile
2	Vision/Mission	0:15 – 0:45	3 bullets, 10s each
3	Facilities + Photo	0:45 – 1:20	Point to photo
4	Chart Results	1:20 – 2:10	Highlight 2024 peak
5	Fees Table	2:10 – 2:50	Row-by-row reveal
6	Co-Curricular	2:50 – 3:20	Mention Robotics win
7	Partnerships	3:20 – 3:45	Name MTN, Orange
8	Video/Audio	3:45 – 4:15	**Let media play fully (30s)**
9	Admissions	4:15 – 4:45	Point to QR code
10	Thank You	4:45 – 5:00	"Questions? Stand B12"

Action: If rehearsal exceeds 5:00, reduce speaker notes on Slides 3, 6, 7; increase animation speed (Duration 0.30s).

8. Output Generation Checklist

- **Done: Handouts (3 slides/page):** `File > Print > Printer: Microsoft Print to PDF > Settings: 3 Slides Handouts > Frame Slides: On > Save as \texttt{GBHS_Handouts.pdf}`. Verify: 4 pages (Slides 1–3, 4–6, 7–9, 10+blank), note lines present.
- **Done: Full PDF:** `File > Export > Create PDF/XPS > Options: Publish what: Slides, Include: Document properties, Document structure tags for accessibility > Publish as \texttt{GBHS_Pr`
- **Done: Package for CD:** `File > Export > Package Presentation for CD > Name: GBHS_OpenDays_Pack > Options: Linked files (checked), Embed TrueType fonts (checked) > Copy to Folder/USB.` Verify folder contains `GBHS_Live.pptx`, `choir_performance.mp4`, `principal_welcome.m4a`, `Logo.png`.

9. Peer Evaluation Checklist (Used during Defense) Each peer group scores the presenting team 1 (Poor) to 5 (Excellent).

Criteria	Descriptors	1	2	3	4	5
Structure & Logic	Clear objective, logical flow, strong opening/closing, signposting.					
Visual Design	Consistent Master (logo, footer, colours), readable fonts (≥24pt), high contrast, 6×6 rule respected, quality images.					
Content Accuracy	Correct data (chart/table), relevant info, no spelling/grammar errors, citations if needed.					
Multimedia Integration	Video/Audio plays smoothly, relevant, trimmed, formatted (poster frame), file size managed.					
Transitions/Animations	Uniform transition, subtle; animations progressive (by paragraph/series), purposeful, not distracting, timed well.					
Timing & Pacing	Total ≤ 5:00 min, slides advance smoothly, speaker not rushed, media accommodated.					
Oral Delivery	Eye contact, voice projection, bilingual (En/Fr) elements, handles Q&A, uses Presenter View/notes naturally.					
Outputs Ready	Handouts (3–up), PDF, Package folder complete and functional on USB.					

Scoring: Total / 40. **Pass mark: 28/40**. The team with the highest score (teacher moderates) submits the final `GBHS_Kiosk.pptx` and `GBHS_Live.pptx` to the Principal via the school's administrative email (`principal@gbhsmbankomo.cm`) and USB key.

WARNING **Common Pitfalls in Integration Activities**

- Forgetting the Master: Formatting each slide individually leads to inconsistency (misaligned logos, varying fonts). Always use Slide Master first.
- Linking vs Embedding Media: Inserting a video from a local path creates a link by default in older versions; in modern 365 it embeds. Always verify in `File > Info > Optimize Media Compatibility` and use Package for CD to ensure files travel with the .pptx.
- Animation Overload: Using "Fly In", "Bounce", "Spin" on every bullet distracts the jury. Stick to one entrance effect (Appear/Wipe/Fade) for the whole deck.
- Chart Junk: 3D charts, excessive gridlines, legend on right taking space. Use 2D Clustered Column, remove vertical gridlines, place legend at bottom.
- Ignoring Kiosk vs Live: A kiosk show must have `Transitions > After: [time]` and

`Video > Start: Automatically`. A live show must have `On Mouse Click` and `Video > Start: On Click`. Save two versions.

- Font Substitution: Using a fancy downloaded font (e.g., "African Sunset") that is not on the presentation PC at the Palais des Congrès. Use system fonts (Calibri, Arial, Segoe UI) or Embed Fonts (File > Options > Save > Embed fonts in the file).

DID YOU KNOW? **Cameroon Context: Digital Skills for Employability**

The ability to produce a polished, self-running multimedia presentation is a core 21st-century skill highlighted in Cameroon's National ICT Policy and the GCE A-Level ICT Syllabus. In the professional world — whether pitching a startup to the Yaoundé Business Plan Competition, presenting a project report at CAMTEL or ANTIC, or defending a thesis at University of Yaoundé I — the standards are identical: structure, visual consistency, technical reliability, and time management. This activity simulates a real Request for Proposal (RFP) scenario where the "client" (the Principal) has strict specifications. Mastering the Slide Master separates amateurs (who format manually) from professionals (who design systems). The Package for CD feature ensures your work survives the "it works on my laptop" syndrome — a classic embarrassment at national events like the Foire Internationale de l'Entreprise (FIE) or Journées de l'Excellence. Treat this exercise as a portfolio piece for your future career.

7 METHODS AND WORKED EXAMPLES

8 GETTING STARTED WITH PRESENTATION SOFTWARE AND PRODUCING SLIDES

A **presentation software** (Microsoft PowerPoint, LibreOffice Impress, Google Slides) is used to produce a sequence of **slides**: pages displayed on a screen or projected, combining text, images, charts, sound and video to support an oral talk. At the GCE Advanced Level you must be able to produce, illustrate, animate and deliver a slide presentation, and to evaluate one critically.

DEFINITION **Slide, layout, presentation**

A **slide** is a single page of a presentation. A **layout** is a predefined arrangement of placeholders (title, text, picture, chart…) on a slide, e.g. Title Slide, Title and Content, Two Content, Comparison, Blank. A **presentation** is the whole file: an ordered set of slides plus its design (theme, master), its effects (transitions, animations) and its media.

8.1 Skill 1: Creating a presentation and choosing an appropriate layout

METHOD **Producing a slide presentation from scratch**

To produce a clean slide presentation with software such as Microsoft PowerPoint or LibreOffice Impress:

1. Plan before you click. On paper, list the title, the sections and one idea per slide. A good rule is one slide = one message.
2. Launch the software and choose New presentation (blank or from a template/design theme).
3. Choose the slide layout (Title Slide, Title and Content, Two Content, Comparison, Blank…) from the Layout menu before typing; changing it later can displace your content.
4. Enter the text in the placeholders. Keep phrases short (keywords, not paragraphs).
5. Insert new slides with New Slide (shortcut `Ctrl+M`) and duplicate or delete slides from the slide pane.
6. Save early and often (`Ctrl+S`) in the correct format: `.pptx` (PowerPoint) or `.odp` (Impress), and keep a copy on a USB key.

7. Check the result in Slide Sorter view, then run the show with `F5`.

Reflexes: title on every slide; maximum about 6 lines per slide and 6 words per line (the "6×6 rule"); save under a meaningful file name, e.g. `Water_Project_Group3.pptx`.

WARNING **Common beginner mistakes**

- Typing whole paragraphs on a slide: the audience reads instead of listening. Details belong to the speech and the speaker notes.
- Choosing the layout after typing: content may jump or disappear.
- Saving only at the end: a power cut (frequent during the rainy season!) can destroy an hour of work. Save every few minutes.

WORKED EXAMPLE 5 **Creating a first presentation**

Statement (GCE style). For the end-of-year open day, your school asks each Upper Sixth class to present one science project. Your group must prepare a 5-slide presentation entitled "Clean Water for Buea". (a) Give the layout you would choose for slide 1 and for slide 3 (which lists three causes of water pollution). (b) Describe the steps to add a fourth slide between slides 3 and 4. (c) State two good practices for the text on the slides.

SOLUTION

Solution.

(a) Slide 1 is the opening slide: choose the **Title Slide** layout, which contains a title placeholder (Clean Water for Buea) and a subtitle placeholder (group members, class, date). Slide 3 presents a list of three causes: choose the **Title and Content** layout, with the title Causes of water pollution and a bulleted list in the content placeholder (domestic waste, chemical fertilisers, leaking latrines).

(b) To insert a slide between slides 3 and 4: click on slide 3 in the slide pane (left panel) or in Slide Sorter view, then click Home → New Slide (or press `Ctrl+M`). The new slide is inserted after the selected one and automatically becomes slide 4; the old slide 4 is renumbered 5. Then choose its layout and type the content.

(c) Good practices for text: (i) use short phrases or keywords rather than full paragraphs, respecting roughly the 6×6 rule; (ii) keep a large, readable font size (at least 24 pt for body text) and the same font throughout the presentation.

Examiner's remark: marks are given for naming the layouts precisely ("Title Slide", "Title and Content") and for stating that insertion happens after the selected slide.

9 DESIGNING ATTRACTIVE AND CONSISTENT SLIDES

9.1 Skill 2: Applying themes, masters and consistent formatting

DEFINITION **Theme and Slide Master**

A **theme** is a coordinated set of colours, fonts and background styles applied to all slides at once. The **Slide Master** is the model slide from which all slides inherit their formatting: any element placed on the master (logo, font, footer, background) is repeated automatically on every slide that uses it.

METHOD **Designing attractive and consistent slides**

To obtain a professional, uniform look:

1. Apply a **theme** (Design tab): it fixes the colour palette, fonts and background of all slides at once.
2. For deeper control, open the **Slide Master** (View → Slide Master): any change made on the master (logo, font, footer, background) is repeated on every slide using that master.
3. Add slide numbers, date and footer via Insert → Header & Footer.
4. Use high contrast: dark text on light background or the reverse; avoid red/green combinations (colour-blind audience).
5. Align and space objects with Arrange → Align / Distribute; group related objects.
6. Limit yourself to two fonts and three colours maximum.

Key idea: consistency is achieved through the master, not by formatting each slide by hand.

WORKED EXAMPLE 6 **Using the Slide Master**

Statement. A student has typed a 20-slide presentation on HIV/AIDS sensitisation in the North West Region. The school now requires that every slide display the school logo at the top right, slide numbers at the bottom right, and the font Calibri. (a) Explain the most efficient way to satisfy these three requirements. (b) The student formatted slide 7 manually with a different font before using the master, and slide 7 does not change. Explain why and propose a remedy. (c) Give two reasons why consistency of design matters in a presentation.

SOLUTION

Solution.

(a) Open View → Slide Master. On the master slide: (i) insert the logo picture (Insert → Picture) and position it at the top right; (ii) select the title and body placeholders and set the font to Calibri; (iii) close the Master view, then use Insert → Header & Footer, tick Slide number, and click Apply to All. Because all 20 slides inherit from the master, the logo, font and numbers appear everywhere in a single operation instead of 20 manual edits.

(b) Manual (local) formatting overrides the master: slide 7 keeps its directly applied font. Remedy: select slide 7 and use Reset (Reset Slide / Reset Layout) to remove local formatting so the slide follows the master again.

(c) Consistency (i) helps the audience focus on the message instead of being distracted by changing styles, and (ii) gives a professional, credible image of the presenter and the school.

Examiner's remark: the phrase "manual formatting overrides the master" is the key marking point in (b).

9.2 Skill 3: Inserting and formatting illustrative objects

METHOD **Illustrating slides with images, tables, charts and SmartArt**

1. Images: Insert → Pictures; resize by a corner handle to keep proportions; use Compress Pictures to reduce file size.
2. Tables: Insert → Table; use them for exact numerical data (e.g. marks, prices).
3. Charts: Insert → Chart; choose the type according to the data: column/bar for comparisons, line for evolution over time, pie for shares of a total (percentages).
4. SmartArt / diagrams: for processes, hierarchies, cycles (e.g. the water cycle).
5. Always add a title or caption and cite the source of borrowed images.
6. Check readability from the back of the room: no chart should need a magnifying glass.

Reflex: a chart replaces a paragraph of numbers; choose the chart type from the nature of the data, not from taste.

KEY POINTS **Choosing the right chart type**

Chart type	Nature of the data	Example
Column / bar	Comparing categories at one moment	Marks of 5 subjects
Line	Evolution of a quantity over time	Subscribers 2018–2023
Pie / doughnut	Shares (percentages) of a total	Sources of internet access
Table	Exact numerical values	Price list in FCFA
SmartArt	Process, hierarchy, cycle	Water cycle, staff organigram

WORKED EXAMPLE 7 **Choosing the right illustration**

Statement. A group presents a survey of 200 students of a school in Yaoundé on their main source of internet access: mobile data 130, home Wi-Fi 40, cybercafé 20, no access 10. (a) Which chart type is most appropriate to show the shares of each source? Justify. (b) Which chart type would be appropriate to show how the number of internet users in the school evolved from 2020 to 2024? (c) The group wants to show the exact figures in a structured way on one slide: which object should they use? (d) State one precaution when inserting a photo downloaded from the internet.

SOLUTION

Solution.

(a) A **pie chart** (or doughnut chart): the four categories are parts of a whole (200 students), and a pie chart displays percentages of a total. The slices would represent 65 %, 20 %, 10 % and 5 % respectively (e.g. 130/200 = 0.65 = 65 %).

(b) A **line chart**: it is the standard choice to show the evolution of a quantity over time (years 2020–2024 on the horizontal axis, number of users on the vertical axis).

(c) A **table**: it presents exact numerical values in rows and columns (Source | Number of students | Percentage), which a chart cannot show precisely.

(d) Precautions (any one): check that the image is free of rights or cite the source; verify the image is of good resolution so it does not appear blurred when projected; compress it so the file stays light.

Examiner's remark: the justification must refer to the nature of the data (parts of a whole → pie; time series → line), which is what earns full marks.

10 MULTIMEDIA, TRANSITIONS AND ANIMATIONS

10.1 Skill 4: Applying transitions and animations

DEFINITION **Transition vs animation**

A **transition** is a visual effect applied between two slides, i.e. the way slide $n + 1$ replaces slide n on the screen. An **animation** is an effect applied to an object inside a slide (text, picture, chart): the four families are Entrance (the object appears), Emphasis (the object is highlighted), Exit (the object disappears) and Motion paths (the object moves).

METHOD **Using transitions and animations correctly**

1. Distinguish the two concepts: a **transition** acts between slides; an **animation** acts on objects within a slide.
2. Transitions: select the slide(s), Transitions tab, choose a sober effect (Fade, Push), set the duration, and choose the advance mode: On mouse click or After a given time. Use Apply to All for uniformity.
3. Animations: select the object, Animations tab, then pick an Entrance, Emphasis, Exit or Motion path effect.
4. Order and time the animations in the Animation Pane: start On Click, With Previous or After Previous.
5. Sobriety rule: one transition for the whole show, at most 1–2 animation effects per slide, each serving a pedagogical purpose (e.g. revealing bullet points one by one).

WARNING **The classic exam trap**

Do not confuse transition and animation. “The slide appears with a fade” is a transition; “the bullet points appear one by one” is an animation. Mixing them up in a GCE answer loses the mark even if the rest is correct.

WORKED EXAMPLE 8 **Planning transitions and animations**

Statement. For a presentation on The fight against malaria in Cameroon, a student wants: (i) all slides to appear with the same discreet effect lasting 1 second; (ii) on slide 4, the

three symptoms of malaria to appear one after another, each when the presenter clicks; (iii) on slide 5, a mosquito picture to move across the screen automatically after the title appears. (a) For each wish, state whether it is a transition or an animation, and give the exact settings. (b) The student applies a different, spectacular transition to each of his 15 slides. Criticise this choice.

SOLUTION

Solution.

(a) (i) Transition: select all slides (`Ctrl+A` in the slide pane), Transitions tab, choose Fade, set Duration = 1.00 s, then click Apply to All. (ii) Animation (Entrance): select the bulleted list of symptoms on slide 4, apply an Entrance effect (e.g. Appear or Fade); in the Animation Pane, set each bullet to start On Click, so the three symptoms appear successively at each click. (iii) Animations combined: give the title an Entrance effect, then select the mosquito picture and apply a Motion path (e.g. a line across the slide); in the Animation Pane set the motion path to start After Previous so it plays automatically once the title has appeared.

(b) Using 15 different spectacular transitions is a mistake: it distracts the audience from the content, looks unprofessional, slows the presentation and can tire the viewers. Good practice is a single sober transition (or none) applied to all slides, with effects reserved for moments where they support understanding.

Examiner's remark: clearly separating transition = between slides and animation = on objects is the core marking point; confusing them loses marks.

10.2 Skill 5: Inserting sound and video (multimedia)

METHOD **Making a presentation multimedia**

1. Insert audio: Insert → Audio (from file). Choose the start mode: Automatically, On Click, or Play across slides for background music.
2. Insert video: Insert → Video; prefer short clips (a few dozen seconds) in common formats (`.mp4`, `.wmv`); trim the clip with the Trim Video tool.
3. Keep media with the file: copy the media files into the same folder as the presentation before inserting, or embed them; otherwise the sound/video will not play on another computer.
4. Test on the presentation computer (the school projector room), not only on your own machine, and check the loudspeakers.
5. Respect copyright: use your own recordings or royalty-free media, and cite sources.

6. Balance: multimedia must illustrate the message (e.g. a 30 s video of a mobile money transaction in a talk on e-commerce), never replace it.

DID YOU KNOW? **Linked or embedded media**

When you insert a sound or video, the software may only store a link (the path to the file on your disk) instead of embedding a copy inside the presentation. This is why a presentation that works perfectly at home can fail on the school computer: the linked file was left behind. Always transport the media files together with the `.pptx` file, or embed them, and test on the target machine.

WORKED EXAMPLE 9 **Embedding multimedia correctly**

Statement. Marie prepares a presentation on Traditional dances of the West Region. She inserts a 3-minute video filmed at a festival in Bafoussam and a background song. (a) At school, on the classroom computer, the video refuses to play and an error message appears. Give two likely causes and the remedy for each. (b) She wants the song to continue while she moves through slides 2 to 6: which option must she activate? (c) The 3-minute video interrupts her talk for too long. Propose two solutions. (d) State one legal precaution concerning the song.

SOLUTION

Solution.

(a) Likely causes and remedies: (i) the video file was only linked, not embedded, and was not copied to the school computer ⇒ copy the video file together with the presentation (same folder) or embed it, then re-insert; (ii) the classroom computer lacks the codec/format support ⇒ convert the video to a widely supported format such as `.mp4` before the presentation. (A third acceptable cause: the file path changed because the presentation was moved.)

(b) She must set the audio to Play across slides (in the Playback options of the audio object), with start Automatically on slide 2 and stop after slide 6 if the tool allows it.

(c) Solutions: (i) use Trim Video to keep only the most illustrative 30–40 seconds; (ii) split the video and show short extracts at the relevant moments, commenting over them, instead of one long uninterrupted clip.

(d) The song is protected by copyright: she should use a royalty-free track, obtain authorisation, or at least cite the artist and source, especially if the presentation will be published online.

Examiner's remark: "linked vs embedded media" and "test on the target machine" are

the classic expected answers for multimedia problems.

11 DELIVERING, PRINTING AND EVALUATING THE PRESENTATION

11.1 Skill 6: Delivering, printing and exporting the presentation

METHOD **Presenting, printing handouts and exporting**

1. Rehearse with Rehearse Timings and check the total duration against the allowed time.
2. Run the show with `F5` (from the beginning) or `Shift+F5` (from the current slide); navigate with arrow keys, `B` to black the screen, `Esc` to quit.
3. Use Presenter View (speaker notes visible to you, slides only to the audience) when available; write speaker notes under each slide.
4. Print handouts: File → Print → Handouts (2, 3, 4, 6 or 9 slides per page); the 3-slide layout leaves lines for the audience's notes. Print Notes Pages for yourself.
5. Export a copy as **PDF** to guarantee identical display on any computer, and keep the editable `.pptx` file.
6. Before the day: copy everything (presentation + media + PDF) on a USB key and test on the actual projector (resolution, sound, cables).

WORKED EXAMPLE 10 **Preparing the delivery**

Statement. A candidate must defend a project in 10 minutes before a jury, using a 12-slide presentation. (a) Explain how he can check, before the jury day, that his speech fits in 10 minutes. (b) The jury asks for a paper document containing all the slides, four per page, to annotate during the defence. Describe how to produce it. (c) On the jury's computer, the fonts of his presentation are replaced and the layout is broken. What should he have done to avoid this? (d) Give two keyboard shortcuts useful during the slide show and their effects.

SOLUTION

Solution.

(a) He uses Slide Show → Rehearse Timings: the software records the time spent on each slide while he practises aloud, and displays the total. If the total exceeds 10 minutes, he shortens his comments or removes a slide, then rehearses again until the timing is correct. He can also save these timings for an automatic show.

(b) File → Print; under Settings, choose Handouts (4 slides per page) (horizontal or vertical order), select the printer and print. The jury then receives every slide in miniature with space around for annotations. (The 3-slides-per-page layout, with ruled lines, is also acceptable if justified.)

(c) He should have exported a PDF copy of the presentation (File → Export/Save As → PDF): a PDF preserves fonts, images and layout exactly on any computer. Alternatively, embedding fonts when saving, or using only standard fonts, reduces the risk.

(d) Any two: `F5` starts the show from the first slide; `Shift+F5` starts from the current slide; `B` (or `W`) temporarily blacks (whites) the screen to refocus attention on the speaker; `Esc` ends the show; arrow keys/`Space` advance to the next slide.

Examiner's remark: in (c), "export to PDF" is the strongest answer because it addresses both fonts and layout.

11.2 Skill 7: Evaluating and improving a presentation (integration)

METHOD **Evaluating a slide presentation with a grid**

To evaluate (or self-evaluate) a presentation, use a criteria grid covering four families:

1. Content: accurate information, clear structure (introduction, development, conclusion), one idea per slide, adapted to the audience and to the time limit.
2. Design: consistent theme/master, readable fonts and sizes, high contrast, limited colours, well-chosen illustrations (correct chart types), no overcrowding.
3. Multimedia and effects: sober transitions, purposeful animations, working sound/video, embedded media.
4. Delivery and technical quality: correct spelling, speaker notes, rehearsed timing, tested on the target machine, PDF/USB backup.

For each criterion, tick Yes/Partially/No, then list concrete improvements. This is exactly the approach expected in the integration activities lesson: produce, present, then critique and improve.

WORKED EXAMPLE 11 **Integration: critiquing and correcting a presentation**

Statement. Here is the description of a classmate's 8-slide presentation on Mobile Money in Cameroon: slide 1 has no title; the text is written in long paragraphs in 14 pt yellow font on a white background; each slide uses a different theme; a pie chart is used to show the evolution of the number of MTN Mobile Money subscribers from 2018 to 2023; every slide has a different spinning transition; a video is inserted but does not play on the school computer; the file is named `doc1.pptx`. Identify six weaknesses and, for each, give the correction.

SOLUTION

Solution. Any six of the following (weakness → correction):

1. Missing title on slide 1 → use the Title Slide layout with the presentation title, the author's name, class and date.
2. Long paragraphs → replace them by short bulleted keywords (about 6 lines per slide); the details belong to the speech and the speaker notes.
3. Unreadable text (14 pt, yellow on white) → increase body text to at least 24 pt and use a high-contrast combination, e.g. dark text on a light background.
4. A different theme per slide → apply a single theme (or the Slide Master) to the whole presentation for visual consistency.
5. Wrong chart type → an evolution over time (2018–2023) must be shown with a line chart (or column chart); a pie chart is only for shares of a total at one moment.
6. Multiple spinning transitions → apply one sober transition (e.g. Fade) to all slides; effects must serve the message, not distract.
7. Video not playing → copy the video file with the presentation (or embed it), use a common format (`.mp4`) and test on the school computer beforehand.
8. Meaningless file name → save as e.g. `MobileMoney_Presentation.pptx` and keep a PDF export plus a USB backup.

Conclusion: after correction, the presentation satisfies the four evaluation families: clear content, consistent and readable design, sober effects, and technical reliability. Examiner's remark: in integration questions, always pair each weakness with its concrete remedy; a list of faults without corrections earns only half the marks.

EXERCISE 5 **Practice: from production to delivery**

Your class must present "The role of ANTIC in securing online services in Cameroon" in 8 minutes.

1. Propose a plan of 6 slides, giving for each slide its title and its layout.
2. State the chart type you would use to show the growth of reported cyber-incidents over five years, and justify.
3. You want a short recorded interview (audio) to play only when you click on slide 4. Give the exact setting.
4. Give three checks to perform on the school computer the day before the presentation.

SOLUTION **Practice: from production to delivery**

1. Example plan: slide 1 Title Slide (title, names, class); slide 2 Title and Content (What is ANTIC? missions); slide 3 Title and Content (services: certificates, awareness); slide 4 Title and Content (recorded interview + audio icon); slide 5 Title and Content (chart of cyber-incidents); slide 6 Title and Content or Blank (conclusion and thanks).
2. A line chart (or column chart): the data describe an evolution over time, which is exactly what a line chart shows; a pie chart would be wrong because the years are not parts of a whole.
3. Select the audio object on slide 4, open the Playback options and set Start: On Click (not Automatically, not Play across slides).
4. Any three: check that the presentation file opens; check that the audio/video media play (embedded or copied with the file); check the projector display and resolution; check the loudspeakers; check that fonts and layout are correct (or use the PDF copy); check that the USB key is readable.

KEY POINTS **Chapter summary**

- Plan first: one slide = one message; choose the layout before typing; save often under a meaningful name.
- Consistency comes from the theme and the Slide Master; manual formatting overrides the master (use Reset to fix).
- Choose illustrations from the nature of the data: pie = shares of a total, line = evolution over time, column = comparison, table = exact values.
- Transition = between slides; animation = on objects (Entrance, Emphasis, Exit, Motion path). Stay sober: one transition, purposeful animations.

- Multimedia: embed or transport media files, use common formats (`.mp4`), respect copyright, and test on the target machine.
- Deliver: rehearse timings, use speaker notes and Presenter View, print handouts, export a PDF backup, and evaluate with a four-family criteria grid.

12 EXERCISES

12.1 I check my knowledge

EXERCISE 6 MCQ: transitions or animations?

For each of the following effects, state whether it is a transition or an animation. Choose the correct letter.

1. A “Fade” effect that appears when moving from Slide 3 to Slide 4.
2. A “Fly In” effect applied to the title text of Slide 2.
3. A “Wipe” effect that makes a chart appear bar by bar on Slide 5.
4. A “Morph” effect that transforms the whole of Slide 6 into Slide 7.

Choices:

a) 1 = transition, 2 = animation, 3 = animation, 4 = transition

b) 1 = animation, 2 = transition, 3 = transition, 4 = animation

c) All four are transitions.

d) All four are animations.

EXERCISE 7 True or false — justify

State whether each statement is true or false, and justify your answer in one or two sentences.

1. The Slide Master allows you to place the school logo and slide numbers on every slide at once.
2. Transitions are effects applied to individual objects (text, images, charts) on a slide.
3. A presentation saved with a video that was only linked (not embedded) will always play correctly on any other computer.
4. The 6×6 rule recommends at most 6 bullet points per slide and at most 6 words per bullet point.

EXERCISE 8 Key definitions

Define each of the following terms in one or two clear sentences, as expected at the GCE Advanced Level:

1. Slide Master
2. Transition
3. Animation
4. Handout
5. Slide Show (presentation mode)

EXERCISE 9 **Direct calculation: timing a slide show**

A student in Upper Sixth prepares a presentation of 12 slides. The slide show is set to advance automatically. Slides 1 to 4 advance after 8 seconds each, slides 5 to 10 after 15 seconds each, and slides 11 and 12 after 20 seconds each.

1. Calculate the total duration of the slide show in seconds.
2. Convert this duration into minutes and seconds.
3. The student must present within a 3-minute limit. By how many seconds must the total timing be reduced?

12.2 I practise

EXERCISE 10 **Restructuring a raw presentation**

Your classmate gives you a raw 8-slide presentation about "The History of Our School". The fonts change from slide to slide, there is no logo, no slide numbers, and the slides are in a random order (the conclusion appears as Slide 3). Describe, step by step, the operations you would perform in the presentation software to:

1. apply a single consistent theme to all slides;
2. use the Slide Master to display the school logo and automatic slide numbers on every slide;
3. reorder the slides into a logical sequence (title, introduction, body, conclusion).

EXERCISE 11 **Inserting and animating a chart**

A school wants to show its GCE Advanced Level pass rates: 72% in 2022, 78% in 2023 and 85% in 2024.

1. Describe how to insert a column chart of these three values on a slide.
2. Explain how to animate the chart series by series (or category by category) so that each year's column appears separately.
3. Explain how to set this slide to advance automatically after 10 seconds.

EXERCISE 12 **Producing handouts and notes pages**

You must give a printed document to an audience of 30 parents during a school open day in Bamenda.

1. Describe the steps to print handouts with 6 slides per page, leaving lines or space where the audience can write notes.
2. Explain in which situations notes pages (one slide plus the speaker's notes) are preferred to handouts.

EXERCISE 13 **Evaluating two slides**

Two slides are presented to you. Slide A contains 12 bullet points of long sentences, yellow text on a white background, three different fonts, a low-quality stretched image and five different animations. Slide B contains 5 short bullet points, dark blue text on a light background, one font, one clear image and one simple transition.

1. Identify five design faults in Slide A.
2. For each fault, propose a correction, referring to the 6×6 rule and to the principles of contrast and consistency.

12.3 I prepare for the GCE

EXERCISE 14 **Structured question: planning a business pitch (8 marks)**

A young entrepreneur in Douala must present a business plan to a bank in order to obtain a loan. He decides to use presentation software.

1. List and explain the five steps for planning an effective presentation, from defining the

objective to rehearsing the delivery. (5 marks)

2. Give three reasons why the Slide Master is useful in preparing this presentation. (3 marks)

EXERCISE 15 **Scenario question: the video that does not play (6 marks)**

During a GCE practice presentation, a student prepares her slides at home and inserts a video stored in a folder on her personal computer. At school, the video refuses to play on the classroom computer, although all the other slides display correctly.

1. Explain the most likely cause of this problem, using the terms linked file and embedded file. (2 marks)

2. Describe two different methods the student could have used to prevent this problem. (4 marks)

EXERCISE 16 **GCE-style essay (10 marks)**

"Animations and transitions always improve a presentation."
Discuss this statement. Your essay should:

1. explain what transitions and animations are, with one example of each;

2. present at least two arguments in favour of using them (with examples, e.g. revealing bullet points progressively, showing a chart series by series);

3. present at least two arguments against their excessive use (with examples, e.g. distraction, loss of time, unprofessional appearance);

4. conclude with clear guidelines for the reasonable use of transitions and animations in an academic or professional presentation.

Your answer should be well structured (introduction, development, conclusion) and illustrated with concrete examples. (10 marks)

13 SOLUTIONS TO THE EXERCISES

13.1 Solutions — I check my knowledge

SOLUTION **Exercise 1 — MCQ: transitions or animations?**

The correct answer is a): 1 = transition, 2 = animation, 3 = animation, 4 = transition. Justification. A **transition** is a visual effect that occurs between two slides, i.e. when the slide show moves from one slide to the next. An **animation** is a visual effect applied to an object inside a single slide (text, picture, chart, shape).

1. The "Fade" appears when moving from Slide 3 to Slide 4: it concerns the passage between two slides ⇒ transition.
2. The "Fly In" is applied to the title text, an object on Slide 2 ⇒ animation.
3. The "Wipe" makes the chart (an object on Slide 5) appear bar by bar ⇒ animation.
4. "Morph" transforms the whole of Slide 6 into Slide 7: it acts between two slides ⇒ transition.

WARNING **The classic trap**

Do not be misled by the name of the effect ("Fade", "Wipe" exist in both families). The only reliable criterion is the target: whole slide / passage between slides = transition; object inside a slide = animation.

SOLUTION **Exercise 2 — True or false**

1. True. The Slide Master controls the layout of all slides: any element placed on it (logo, slide number field, footer, background) is automatically reproduced on every slide using that master, in a single operation.
2. False. Effects applied to individual objects are animations. Transitions apply to the passage between two slides, not to objects.
3. False. A linked video is not copied into the presentation file; the file only stores the path to the video. If the video is not copied with the presentation (or the path changes), it will not play on another computer. Only an embedded video travels with the file.
4. True. The 6×6 rule is a readability guideline: maximum 6 bullet points per slide and

maximum 6 words per bullet point, so that slides remain airy and the audience listens to the speaker instead of reading.

SOLUTION **Exercise 3 — Key definitions**

1. Slide Master: the model slide that stores the common design (theme, fonts, colours, logo, footer, slide numbers) of a presentation. Any change made on the master is automatically applied to all the slides that depend on it.
2. Transition: a visual effect that plays when the slide show moves from one slide to the next (e.g. Fade, Morph, Push).
3. Animation: a visual effect applied to an object (text, image, chart) within a slide, controlling how and when it appears, is emphasised or disappears (e.g. Fly In, Wipe).
4. Handout: a printed version of the presentation showing several miniatures of slides per page (typically 2, 3, 4, 6 or 9), given to the audience so they can follow and take notes.
5. Slide Show (presentation mode): the full-screen playback mode in which the presentation is displayed to the audience, with its transitions, animations and timings, starting from the current or the first slide.

SOLUTION **Exercise 4 — Direct calculation: timing a slide show**

METHOD **Calculating total slide show duration**

- List each group of slides with its individual duration.
- Multiply the number of slides by the duration per slide for each group.
- Sum all the products to obtain the total duration in seconds.
- Convert seconds to minutes and seconds (divide by 60).
- Compare with the time limit to decide if reduction is needed.

1. Total duration:

$$T = \underbrace{4 \times 8}_{\text{slides 1–4}} + \underbrace{6 \times 15}_{\text{slides 5–10}} + \underbrace{2 \times 20}_{\text{slides 11–12}}$$
$$= 32 + 90 + 40 = 162 \text{ s}.$$

2. Conversion: $162 = 2 \times 60 + 42$, so the show lasts 2 minutes 42 seconds.

3. The limit is 3 minutes = 180 s. Since $162 < 180$, the show is already within the limit: it must be reduced by $162 - 180 = -18$ s, i.e. no reduction is needed; the student even has 18 seconds of margin.

WARNING **Read before computing**

Question 3 is a trap: many candidates compute $180 - 162 = 18$ and answer "reduce by 18 s". Always compare first: here the timing is below the limit, so nothing must be removed.

13.2 Solutions — I practise

SOLUTION **Exercise 5 — Restructuring a raw presentation**

1. Apply one consistent theme. Open the Design tab, choose a single theme in the Themes gallery and click it: it is applied to the whole presentation at once (fonts, colours, background). If needed, use the Variants group to adjust the colour scheme and font set. This immediately removes the mixture of fonts.

2. Add logo and slide numbers via the Slide Master. Go to View → Slide Master. Select the top (parent) master so the change affects all layouts. Use Insert → Pictures to place the school logo (e.g. top-right corner), then Insert → Slide Number (or Header & Footer, tick Slide number, then Apply to All). Close the Master view: the logo and automatic numbers now appear on every slide.

3. Reorder the slides. Switch to View → Slide Sorter (or the left thumbnail pane in Normal view). Drag and drop the thumbnails into a logical order: (1) title slide, (2) introduction/outline, (3–6) body in chronological order of the school's history, (7) conclusion, (8) references/thank-you. Move the conclusion from position 3 to the end. Finally, run the slide show from the beginning to check the new sequence.

DID YOU KNOW? **Cameroon context**

In many Cameroonian schools (e.g. GBHS Bamenda, Lycée Leclerc Yaoundé), the ICT practical exam requires candidates to demonstrate Slide Master usage. A common task: insert the school logo (often the coat of arms) and automatic slide numbers on all slides in under two minutes — only the Master makes this possible.

SOLUTION **Exercise 6 — Inserting and animating a chart**

1. Inserting the column chart. On the slide, go to Insert → Chart, choose Column → Clustered Column and validate. A small data sheet opens: enter the categories 2022, 2023, 2024 and the values 72, 78, 85 (as one series "Pass rate (%)"). Close the data sheet; add a chart title such as "GCE A-Level pass rate".
2. Animating series by series / category by category. Select the chart, open the Animations tab and choose an entrance effect (e.g. Wipe or Appear). Then open Effect Options and set Sequence to By Category (or "By Series"): each year's column now appears separately, on a click or automatically after the previous one. This lets the speaker comment on each year as it appears.
3. Automatic advance after 10 s. Select the slide, go to the Transitions tab, in the Timing group untick On Mouse Click (optional), tick After and enter 00:10.00. The slide will advance automatically 10 seconds after it appears.

WARNING **Chart animation trap**

If you choose "As One Object" the whole chart appears at once — no progressive reveal. Always select By Category or By Series in Effect Options to animate data elements individually.

SOLUTION **Exercise 7 — Producing handouts and notes pages**

1. Handouts, 6 slides per page. Go to File → Print. In the Settings section, open the layout menu ("Full Page Slides" by default) and under Handouts choose 6 Slides Horizontal (or Vertical). This layout leaves free space around the miniatures where parents can write; choosing the 3 Slides layout instead gives ruled lines next to each slide. Set the number of copies to 30, check the preview, then print.

2. When notes pages are preferred. Notes pages (one slide at the top, the speaker's notes below) are intended for the presenter, not the audience. They are preferred when: rehearsing the talk; the speech must be delivered by someone else (a colleague replaces the speaker); the presentation is archived as a complete document; or detailed explanations, figures and sources must accompany each slide without overloading the slide itself. Handouts remain the right choice for the audience.

DID YOU KNOW? **Printing in Cameroon**

Many schools print handouts on shared network printers (often managed by CAMTEL or MTN Business solutions). Always preview in Print Preview to avoid wasting paper — a real concern when printing 30 copies for a PTA meeting at a rural school.

SOLUTION **Exercise 8 — Evaluating two slides**

1. Five faults of Slide A: (i) 12 long bullet points — information overload; (ii) yellow text on white background — insufficient contrast, unreadable; (iii) three different fonts — inconsistency; (iv) a stretched, low-quality image — distorted and unprofessional; (v) five different animations — distracting visual noise.

2. Corrections:

Fault	Correction
12 long bullets	Apply the 6×6 rule: at most 6 bullets of at most 6 words; split the content over two slides and let the speech carry the details.
Yellow on white	Respect contrast: dark text on a light background (or the reverse), e.g. dark blue on white as in Slide B.
Three fonts	Consistency: one single font (at most two: one for titles, one for body), fixed in the Slide Master.
Stretched image	Insert a good-resolution image and resize it by the corner handles only, keeping the proportions (aspect ratio).
Five animations	Keep at most one simple, purposeful animation (e.g. reveal bullets progressively) and one discreet transition for the whole deck.

Slide B follows all these principles: it is the model to imitate.

13.3 Solutions — I prepare for the GCE

SOLUTION **Exercise 9 — Structured question: planning a business pitch**

Indicative mark scheme (8 marks). Question 1: 1 mark per correctly named and explained step (5 × 1). Question 2: 1 mark per valid reason (3 × 1). Naming without explanation earns at most half the marks.

1. The five steps of planning (5 marks):

1. Define the objective: decide what the presentation must achieve — here, convince the bank to grant the loan. Every slide must serve this goal.
2. Analyse the audience: bankers expect figures, reliability and seriousness; the content, vocabulary and sober design are adapted accordingly.
3. Plan and structure the content: build an outline — introduction, presentation of the business, market study, financial plan, loan requested, conclusion — and select only the essential points.
4. Design and produce the slides: apply a consistent theme and Slide Master, respect the 6×6 rule, insert clear charts (e.g. projected revenue) rather than long text.
5. Rehearse and check the delivery: run the slide show, time it, check transitions, media and spelling, and practise speaking with the slides until the timing fits the appointment.

2. Three reasons the Slide Master is useful (3 marks):

1. Consistency: it guarantees the same fonts, colours and layout on all slides, giving a professional image to the bank.
2. Time saving: the logo, footer and slide numbers are inserted once on the master instead of slide by slide.
3. Easy global modification: changing the design (e.g. the colour scheme) on the master updates the whole presentation instantly, avoiding inconsistencies.

Examiner's expectations: structured answer, correct vocabulary (objective, audience, outline, master), and reasons clearly linked to the banking context.

SOLUTION **Exercise 10 — Scenario question: the video that does not play**

Indicative mark scheme (6 marks). (a) 1 mark for identifying linking as the cause, 1 mark for the explanation with correct terms. (b) 2 marks per method (1 for the method, 1 for the description), 2 × 2 = 4.

1. Most likely cause (2 marks). At home the student inserted the video as a linked file: the presentation only stores the path to the video on her personal computer (e.g. `C:\Users\...\video.mp4`), not the video itself. On the classroom computer this path does not exist, so the link is broken and the video cannot play, while the rest of the slides — which are embedded in the file — display normally. An embedded file, by contrast, is

physically copied inside the presentation and travels with it.
2. Two prevention methods (4 marks).

1. Embed the video: insert it so that it is copied into the presentation file (or use Insert → Video then save in a format that embeds media). The file becomes heavier, but it is self-contained and plays on any computer.
2. Copy the video together with the presentation, keeping the link valid: place the video in the same folder as the presentation before inserting it, then copy the whole folder (e.g. on a USB flash drive) to the school computer without changing the relative paths. One can also use the Package/Export for CD feature, which gathers the presentation and all linked media automatically.

Examiner's expectations: the pair linked/embedded must be used correctly; any two coherent, technically valid methods are accepted.

DID YOU KNOW? **ANTIC recommendation**

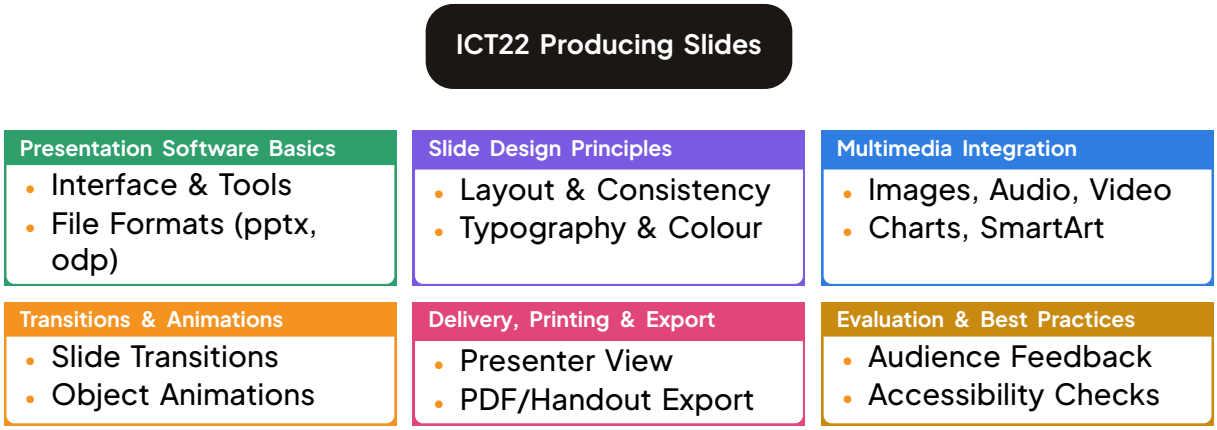
The National Agency for Information and Communication Technologies (ANTIC) recommends embedding media for official presentations (e.g. MINEDUB reports) to avoid broken links during inter-ministerial meetings where USB drives move between different Windows versions.

SOLUTION **Exercise 11 — GCE-style essay**

Indicative mark scheme (10 marks): definitions with examples 2 marks; two arguments in favour with examples 2 marks; two arguments against with examples 2 marks; guidelines 2 marks; structure (introduction, development, conclusion) and quality of expression 2 marks.
Model answer.
Introduction. Modern presentation software offers two families of effects: transitions, which animate the passage from one slide to the next (e.g. a Fade between two slides), and animations, which animate objects inside a slide (e.g. a title that flies in). The claim that they "always improve" a presentation deserves discussion: used with measure they help, used in excess they harm.
Arguments in favour. First, animations control the flow of information: revealing bullet points one by one keeps the audience focused on the point being discussed instead of reading ahead. Secondly, they can clarify data: animating a chart series by series (for example the GCE pass rates year by year) lets the speaker comment on each value as it appears. A discreet transition, finally, gives rhythm and signals a change of section.
Arguments against excess. First, too many effects distract: five different animations on one slide draw attention to the effects rather than to the message. Secondly, they waste time and can look unprofessional: a bank manager or an examiner faced with spinning text

and sound effects will doubt the seriousness of the speaker; long effects also lengthen the show and may break the timing.
Guidelines. Use at most one transition (e.g. Fade) applied consistently to the whole presentation; use animations only when they serve the message (progressive reveal, chart by series); prefer fast, sober effects without sound; and always rehearse to check that the effects do not slow the delivery.
Conclusion. Transitions and animations improve a presentation only when they are purposeful, consistent and discreet. The statement is therefore false in its absolute form: the effect must serve the content, never replace it.
Examiner's expectations: a genuine discussion (both sides), precise vocabulary, concrete examples, and a justified personal conclusion — a purely one-sided essay cannot earn full marks.

14 SUMMARY SHEET



Mind map of ICT22: Producing Slides that Display Illustrative and Attractive Presentations

FICHE BILAN **L'essentiel à connaître pour l'examen**

Key Definitions

- **Presentation software**: Application (e.g. LibreOffice Impress, Microsoft PowerPoint) used to create, edit and display slide decks.
- **Slide master**: Template that defines default layout, fonts, colours and placeholders for all slides.
- **Transition**: Visual effect applied when moving from one slide to the next.
- **Animation**: Effect applied to individual objects (text, images, charts) within a slide.
- **Multimedia**: Integration of non-text media — images, audio, video, charts, SmartArt — into slides.
- **Presenter view**: Mode showing current slide, next slide, notes and timer on the speaker's screen only.

Laws / Principles / Formulas (Examinable)

- Consistency rule: Use a single slide master; limit fonts to two families (heading + body) and a palette of 3–4 colours.
- 6×6 guideline: Maximum six bullet points per slide, six words per bullet.
- Contrast principle: Text/background contrast ratio ≥ 4.5:1 (WCAG AA) for readability.
- Animation hierarchy: Entrance → Emphasis → Exit; avoid simultaneous multiple animations on one object.

- File size optimisation: Compress images (≤ 150 dpi for screen, ≤ 300 dpi for print); embed only used fonts.

Methods (Step-by-Step)

METHOD **Creating a Consistent Slide Deck**

- Open the software and choose a blank presentation.
- Define a **Slide Master**: set theme colours, heading/body fonts, logo placeholder, footer (date, slide number).
- Insert slides using predefined layouts (Title, Title+Content, Two Content, etc.).
- Apply the 6×6 guideline; keep text concise, use keywords.
- Insert multimedia via `Insert → Media`; resize proportionally (hold Shift).
- Add transitions: `Transitions tab → Choose effect → Set duration → Apply to All` (or per slide).
- Animate objects: `Animations tab → Add Animation → Set Start (On Click/After Previous) → Adjust timing.`
- Rehearse with **Presenter View**; check timing, notes, laser pointer.
- Export: `File → Export → Create PDF/XPS` for handouts; `Package Presentation for CD` for offline delivery.

METHOD **Evaluating a Presentation**

- Run a peer review: checklist for clarity, visual hierarchy, spelling, accessibility (alt text for images).
- Collect audience feedback (Google Form, Mentimeter) on content relevance and delivery pace.
- Record timings; adjust slide count or animation speed if over/under allotted time.

Common Mistakes (Traps)

WARNING **Frequent Errors**

- Overloading slides with paragraphs instead of bullet points.
- Using more than three font families or clashing colour schemes.
- Applying different transitions on every slide → distracts audience.
- Animating every object; results in chaotic, unprofessional effect.
- Forgetting to embed fonts or compress images → huge file, playback issues on other machines.
- Neglecting alt text for images → fails accessibility checks.
- Not testing Presenter View on the actual projection hardware before the exam/presentation.

GCE Advanced Level Tips

KEY POINTS **Exam-Focused Advice**

- Practical paper: You will be asked to produce a 6–8 slide deck in 45 min. Master the Slide Master first; it saves time.
- Theory questions: Define transition vs animation; state the 6×6 rule; explain why compressing images matters.
- Short-answer: "Give two ways to ensure a presentation is accessible." → Alt text, high contrast, readable font size (≥ 24 pt).
- Scenario: "A slide contains a 5 MB video. The file must be emailed (limit 10 MB). What do you do?" → Compress video, link to online storage, or convert to lower resolution.
- Keyboard shortcuts: `Ctrl+M` (new slide), `F5` (start show), `Shift+F5` (start from current), `Ctrl+P` (pen in show).
- Cameroon context: Mention using MTN/Orange mobile data to upload to Google Drive for collaboration; reference ANTIC guidelines for secure presentation sharing in e-government.

Signed • OnBuch+
ONBUCH+ TEACHING TEAM
FOLLOWS THE OFFICIAL MINESEC SYLLABUS

OnBuch+